Sample Mortgage Bank Limited

Mortgage Loan Policy

Version 5.0

Item	Detail
Effective date	01-Jun-2023
Supersedes	Version 4.0 (effective 01-Jul-2022)
Total pages	600
Owner	Retail Credit Policy Department
Classification	Internal. Synthetic document created only for RAG testing - not a real bank policy.

Document Control

Version	Effective date	Supersedes	Status
5.0	01-Jun-2023	4.0	In force from the effective date

Summary of changes from the previous version

The following 3 changes were made compared with version 4.0. All other terms are unchanged.

No.	Parameter	Previous	Revised
1	Minimum age of applicant	21 years	23 years
2	Maximum age at loan maturity	65 years	70 years
3	Self-employed minimum business vintage	3 years	2 years

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Part A - Mortgage Loan Policy

1. Purpose and Scope

1.1 This Mortgage Loan Policy (the Policy) sets out eligibility, pricing, sanction and servicing norms for mortgage loans offered by Sample Mortgage Bank Limited (the Bank) to individual borrowers. This is Version 5.0, effective 01-Jun-2023.

1.2 Version precedence: where two versions of this Policy differ, the latest effective version prevails for all new applications. An earlier version continues to apply only to loans sanctioned during that version's effective period.

1.3 Products covered by this Policy:

- Home purchase loan
- Home construction loan
- Home improvement loan
- Loan against property (LAP)

2. Eligibility

The Bank assesses every applicant against the criteria below. An application that does not meet a criterion is declined unless an exception is approved in writing under the exception process of this Policy.

2.1 The minimum age of the applicant at the time of application is 23 years. The maximum age of the applicant at loan maturity is 70 years.

2.2 The minimum credit score required is 700. Applications below this score are declined.

2.3 Self-employed applicants must have a minimum business vintage of 2 years.

2.4 Non-Resident Indians (NRI) are eligible. The maximum LTV for NRI applicants is 70% irrespective of loan amount.

Table 1: Eligibility summary

Criterion	Requirement
Minimum age at application	23 years
Maximum age at maturity	70 years
Minimum credit score	700
Self-employed business vintage	At least 2 years
NRI applicants	Eligible, maximum LTV 70%

3. Loan Quantum

3.1 Minimum loan amount: Rs 10 lakh. Maximum loan amount: Rs 2.5 crore per borrower.

3.2 The maximum Loan-to-Value (LTV) ratio depends on the loan amount requested: up to Rs 30 lakh: 85%; above Rs 30 lakh and up to Rs 75 lakh: 80%; above Rs 75 lakh: 75%.

Table 2: Maximum LTV by loan amount

Loan amount requested	Maximum LTV
Up to Rs 30 lakh	85%
Above Rs 30 lakh and up to Rs 75 lakh	80%
Above Rs 75 lakh	75%

3.3 The maximum Fixed Obligation to Income Ratio (FOIR) is 55% of net monthly income. Maximum permissible EMI = FOIR x net monthly income - existing monthly obligations.

4. Tenure

4.1 The maximum loan tenure is 30 years, subject to the maximum age at maturity in clause 2.1.

5. Pricing and Charges

5.1 Floating interest rate = Bank Reference Rate (BRR) + spread. Under this version the BRR is 8.25% per annum and the spread is 2.75% per annum, so the applicable floating rate is 11.00% per annum.

5.2 Processing fee: 0.75% of the sanctioned loan amount, exclusive of taxes.

5.3 Valuation fee: Rs 3,000 per property, non-refundable.

5.4 Penal charge on overdue EMI: 18% per annum on the overdue amount, calculated daily on a 365-day year.

5.5 Prepayment / foreclosure charge on floating rate loans to individual borrowers: 1% of the principal amount prepaid.

Table 3: Summary of charges

Charge	Rate / amount	Basis
Interest rate (floating)	11.00% p.a.	BRR + spread
Processing fee	0.75%	Sanctioned loan amount, excl. taxes
Valuation fee	Rs 3,000	Per property
Penal charge on overdue EMI	18% p.a.	Overdue amount, daily, 365-day year
Prepayment charge (floating)	1%	Principal amount prepaid

6. Security and Insurance

6.1 Mortgage of the financed property is mandatory. Property (fire and allied perils) insurance is mandatory. Life insurance cover for the primary borrower is optional.

7. Sanction and Disbursement

7.1 A sanction letter is valid for 120 days from the date of issue. If the loan is not disbursed within the validity period the sanction lapses.

8. Special Features

8.1 Top-up loan: existing borrowers with a satisfactory repayment track record may avail a top-up of up to 50% of the outstanding principal.

9. Sanctioning Authority

9.1 Branches are graded A, B and C. Maximum loan a branch may sanction: Grade A - Rs 150 lakh; Grade B - Rs 75 lakh; Grade C - Rs 40 lakh. Loans above the branch limit must be referred to the Regional Credit Committee.

Table 4: Branch sanction limits

Branch grade	Maximum loan the branch may sanction
Grade A	Rs 150 lakh
Grade B	Rs 75 lakh
Grade C	Rs 40 lakh

10. Annexures

10.1 Annexure A (Branch Master) and Annexure B (Document Retention Register) are placed at the end of this document.

Part B - Operating Guidelines

Part B sets out the operating procedures that support the Policy in Part A. Each chapter deals with one function and is divided into five sections: objective, roles, procedure, exceptions and records.

Chapter 11: Credit appraisal (Part 1)

11.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the credit appraisal requirements described in chapter 11. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on credit appraisal is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

11.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the credit appraisal requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the credit appraisal activities in chapter 11.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

11.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for credit appraisal is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 11.3: Stages and time limits - credit appraisal

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

11.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the credit appraisal requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving repayment capacity and existing obligations that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

11.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to credit appraisal are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on credit appraisal to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 11.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 11.5: Reporting calendar - credit appraisal

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 12: Income assessment (Part 1)

12.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the income assessment requirements described in chapter 12. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to the stability and verifiability of income.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on income assessment is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

12.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the income assessment requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to the stability and verifiability of income.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the income assessment activities in chapter 12.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

12.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for income assessment is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 12.3: Stages and time limits - income assessment

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

12.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the income assessment requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving the stability and verifiability of income that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

12.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to income assessment are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on income assessment to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 12.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 12.5: Reporting calendar - income assessment

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 13: Property valuation (Part 1)

13.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the property valuation requirements described in chapter 13. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to market value and condition of the property.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on property valuation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

13.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the property valuation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to market value and condition of the property.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the property valuation activities in chapter 13.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

13.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for property valuation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 13.3: Stages and time limits - property valuation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

13.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the property valuation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving market value and condition of the property that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

13.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to property valuation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on property valuation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 13.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 13.5: Reporting calendar - property valuation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 14: Legal and title scrutiny (Part 1)

14.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the legal and title scrutiny requirements described in chapter 14. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and marketable title.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on legal and title scrutiny is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

14.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the legal and title scrutiny requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and marketable title.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the legal and title scrutiny activities in chapter 14.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

14.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for legal and title scrutiny is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 14.3: Stages and time limits - legal and title scrutiny

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

14.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the legal and title scrutiny requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and marketable title that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

14.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to legal and title scrutiny are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on legal and title scrutiny to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 14.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 14.5: Reporting calendar - legal and title scrutiny

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 15: KYC and anti-money-laundering checks (Part 1)

15.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements described in chapter 15. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to customer identity and source of funds.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

15.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to customer identity and source of funds.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks activities in chapter 15.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

15.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 15.3: Stages and time limits - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

15.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving customer identity and source of funds that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

15.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to kyc and anti-money-laundering checks are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 15.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 15.5: Reporting calendar - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 16: Loan documentation (Part 1)

16.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the loan documentation requirements described in chapter 16. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on loan documentation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

16.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the loan documentation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the loan documentation activities in chapter 16.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

16.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for loan documentation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 16.3: Stages and time limits - loan documentation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

16.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the loan documentation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving completeness and accuracy of signed documents that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

16.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to loan documentation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on loan documentation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 16.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 16.5: Reporting calendar - loan documentation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 17: Disbursement conditions (Part 1)

17.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the disbursement conditions requirements described in chapter 17. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on disbursement conditions is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

17.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the disbursement conditions requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the disbursement conditions activities in chapter 17.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

17.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for disbursement conditions is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 17.3: Stages and time limits - disbursement conditions

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

17.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the disbursement conditions requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving conditions to be met before funds are released that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

17.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to disbursement conditions are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on disbursement conditions to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 17.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 17.5: Reporting calendar - disbursement conditions

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 18: Collections and recovery (Part 1)

18.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the collections and recovery requirements described in chapter 18. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on collections and recovery is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

18.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the collections and recovery requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the collections and recovery activities in chapter 18.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

18.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for collections and recovery is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 18.3: Stages and time limits - collections and recovery

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

18.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the collections and recovery requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

18.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to collections and recovery are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on collections and recovery to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 18.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 18.5: Reporting calendar - collections and recovery

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 19: Customer grievance handling (Part 1)

19.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer grievance handling requirements described in chapter 19. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer grievance handling is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

19.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer grievance handling requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer grievance handling activities in chapter 19.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

19.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer grievance handling is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 19.3: Stages and time limits - customer grievance handling

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

19.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer grievance handling requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

19.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer grievance handling are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer grievance handling to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 19.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 19.5: Reporting calendar - customer grievance handling

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 20: Internal audit and compliance (Part 1)

20.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the internal audit and compliance requirements described in chapter 20. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on internal audit and compliance is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

20.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the internal audit and compliance requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the internal audit and compliance activities in chapter 20.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

20.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for internal audit and compliance is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 20.3: Stages and time limits - internal audit and compliance

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

20.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the internal audit and compliance requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

20.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to internal audit and compliance are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on internal audit and compliance to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 20.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 20.5: Reporting calendar - internal audit and compliance

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 21: Data privacy and record keeping (Part 1)

21.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the data privacy and record keeping requirements described in chapter 21. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to safe handling of personal information.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on data privacy and record keeping is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

21.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the data privacy and record keeping requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to safe handling of personal information.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the data privacy and record keeping activities in chapter 21.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

21.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for data privacy and record keeping is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 21.3: Stages and time limits - data privacy and record keeping

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

21.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the data privacy and record keeping requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving safe handling of personal information that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

21.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to data privacy and record keeping are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on data privacy and record keeping to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 21.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 21.5: Reporting calendar - data privacy and record keeping

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 22: Fraud monitoring (Part 1)

22.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the fraud monitoring requirements described in chapter 22. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on fraud monitoring is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

22.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the fraud monitoring requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the fraud monitoring activities in chapter 22.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

22.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for fraud monitoring is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 22.3: Stages and time limits - fraud monitoring

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

22.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the fraud monitoring requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving red-flag indicators and escalation that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

22.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to fraud monitoring are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on fraud monitoring to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 22.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 22.5: Reporting calendar - fraud monitoring

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 23: Customer communication (Part 1)

23.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer communication requirements described in chapter 23. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and timely communication to customers.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer communication is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

23.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer communication requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and timely communication to customers.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer communication activities in chapter 23.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

23.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer communication is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 23.3: Stages and time limits - customer communication

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

23.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer communication requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and timely communication to customers that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

23.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer communication are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer communication to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 23.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 23.5: Reporting calendar - customer communication

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 24: Staff training and certification (Part 1)

24.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the staff training and certification requirements described in chapter 24. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on staff training and certification is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

24.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the staff training and certification requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the staff training and certification activities in chapter 24.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

24.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for staff training and certification is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 24.3: Stages and time limits - staff training and certification

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

24.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the staff training and certification requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

24.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to staff training and certification are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on staff training and certification to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 24.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 24.5: Reporting calendar - staff training and certification

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 25: Credit appraisal (Part 2)

25.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the credit appraisal requirements described in chapter 25. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on credit appraisal is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

25.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the credit appraisal requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the credit appraisal activities in chapter 25.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

25.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for credit appraisal is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 25.3: Stages and time limits - credit appraisal

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

25.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the credit appraisal requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving repayment capacity and existing obligations that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

25.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to credit appraisal are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on credit appraisal to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 25.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 25.5: Reporting calendar - credit appraisal

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 26: Income assessment (Part 2)

26.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the income assessment requirements described in chapter 26. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to the stability and verifiability of income.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on income assessment is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

26.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the income assessment requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to the stability and verifiability of income.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the income assessment activities in chapter 26.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

26.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for income assessment is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 26.3: Stages and time limits - income assessment

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

26.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the income assessment requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving the stability and verifiability of income that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

26.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to income assessment are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on income assessment to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 26.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 26.5: Reporting calendar - income assessment

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 27: Property valuation (Part 2)

27.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the property valuation requirements described in chapter 27. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to market value and condition of the property.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on property valuation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

27.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the property valuation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to market value and condition of the property.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the property valuation activities in chapter 27.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

27.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for property valuation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 27.3: Stages and time limits - property valuation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

27.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the property valuation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving market value and condition of the property that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

27.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to property valuation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on property valuation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 27.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 27.5: Reporting calendar - property valuation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 28: Legal and title scrutiny (Part 2)

28.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the legal and title scrutiny requirements described in chapter 28. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and marketable title.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on legal and title scrutiny is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

28.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the legal and title scrutiny requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and marketable title.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the legal and title scrutiny activities in chapter 28.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

28.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for legal and title scrutiny is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 28.3: Stages and time limits - legal and title scrutiny

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

28.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the legal and title scrutiny requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and marketable title that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

28.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to legal and title scrutiny are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on legal and title scrutiny to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 28.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 28.5: Reporting calendar - legal and title scrutiny

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 29: KYC and anti-money-laundering checks (Part 2)

29.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements described in chapter 29. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to customer identity and source of funds.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

29.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to customer identity and source of funds.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks activities in chapter 29.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

29.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 29.3: Stages and time limits - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

29.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving customer identity and source of funds that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

29.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to kyc and anti-money-laundering checks are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 29.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 29.5: Reporting calendar - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 30: Loan documentation (Part 2)

30.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the loan documentation requirements described in chapter 30. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on loan documentation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

30.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the loan documentation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the loan documentation activities in chapter 30.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

30.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for loan documentation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 30.3: Stages and time limits - loan documentation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

30.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the loan documentation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving completeness and accuracy of signed documents that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

30.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to loan documentation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on loan documentation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 30.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 30.5: Reporting calendar - loan documentation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 31: Disbursement conditions (Part 2)

31.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the disbursement conditions requirements described in chapter 31. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on disbursement conditions is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

31.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the disbursement conditions requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the disbursement conditions activities in chapter 31.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

31.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for disbursement conditions is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 31.3: Stages and time limits - disbursement conditions

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

31.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the disbursement conditions requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving conditions to be met before funds are released that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

31.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to disbursement conditions are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on disbursement conditions to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 31.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 31.5: Reporting calendar - disbursement conditions

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 32: Collections and recovery (Part 2)

32.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the collections and recovery requirements described in chapter 32. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on collections and recovery is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

32.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the collections and recovery requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the collections and recovery activities in chapter 32.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

32.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for collections and recovery is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 32.3: Stages and time limits - collections and recovery

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

32.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the collections and recovery requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

32.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to collections and recovery are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on collections and recovery to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 32.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 32.5: Reporting calendar - collections and recovery

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 33: Customer grievance handling (Part 2)

33.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer grievance handling requirements described in chapter 33. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer grievance handling is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

33.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer grievance handling requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer grievance handling activities in chapter 33.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

33.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer grievance handling is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 33.3: Stages and time limits - customer grievance handling

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

33.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer grievance handling requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

33.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer grievance handling are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer grievance handling to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 33.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 33.5: Reporting calendar - customer grievance handling

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 34: Internal audit and compliance (Part 2)

34.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the internal audit and compliance requirements described in chapter 34. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on internal audit and compliance is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

34.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the internal audit and compliance requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the internal audit and compliance activities in chapter 34.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

34.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for internal audit and compliance is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 34.3: Stages and time limits - internal audit and compliance

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

34.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the internal audit and compliance requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

34.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to internal audit and compliance are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on internal audit and compliance to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 34.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 34.5: Reporting calendar - internal audit and compliance

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 35: Data privacy and record keeping (Part 2)

35.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the data privacy and record keeping requirements described in chapter 35. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to safe handling of personal information.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on data privacy and record keeping is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

35.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the data privacy and record keeping requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to safe handling of personal information.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the data privacy and record keeping activities in chapter 35.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

35.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for data privacy and record keeping is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 35.3: Stages and time limits - data privacy and record keeping

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

35.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the data privacy and record keeping requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving safe handling of personal information that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

35.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to data privacy and record keeping are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on data privacy and record keeping to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 35.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 35.5: Reporting calendar - data privacy and record keeping

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 36: Fraud monitoring (Part 2)

36.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the fraud monitoring requirements described in chapter 36. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on fraud monitoring is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

36.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the fraud monitoring requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the fraud monitoring activities in chapter 36.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

36.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for fraud monitoring is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 36.3: Stages and time limits - fraud monitoring

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

36.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the fraud monitoring requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving red-flag indicators and escalation that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

36.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to fraud monitoring are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on fraud monitoring to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 36.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 36.5: Reporting calendar - fraud monitoring

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 37: Customer communication (Part 2)

37.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer communication requirements described in chapter 37. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and timely communication to customers.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer communication is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

37.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer communication requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and timely communication to customers.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer communication activities in chapter 37.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

37.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer communication is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 37.3: Stages and time limits - customer communication

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

37.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer communication requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and timely communication to customers that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

37.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer communication are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer communication to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 37.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 37.5: Reporting calendar - customer communication

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 38: Staff training and certification (Part 2)

38.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the staff training and certification requirements described in chapter 38. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on staff training and certification is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

38.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the staff training and certification requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the staff training and certification activities in chapter 38.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

38.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for staff training and certification is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 38.3: Stages and time limits - staff training and certification

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

38.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the staff training and certification requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

38.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to staff training and certification are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on staff training and certification to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 38.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 38.5: Reporting calendar - staff training and certification

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 39: Credit appraisal (Part 3)

39.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the credit appraisal requirements described in chapter 39. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on credit appraisal is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

39.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the credit appraisal requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the credit appraisal activities in chapter 39.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

39.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for credit appraisal is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 39.3: Stages and time limits - credit appraisal

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

39.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the credit appraisal requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving repayment capacity and existing obligations that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

39.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to credit appraisal are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on credit appraisal to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 39.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 39.5: Reporting calendar - credit appraisal

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 40: Income assessment (Part 3)

40.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the income assessment requirements described in chapter 40. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to the stability and verifiability of income.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on income assessment is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

40.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the income assessment requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to the stability and verifiability of income.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the income assessment activities in chapter 40.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

40.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for income assessment is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 40.3: Stages and time limits - income assessment

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

40.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the income assessment requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving the stability and verifiability of income that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

40.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to income assessment are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on income assessment to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 40.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 40.5: Reporting calendar - income assessment

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 41: Property valuation (Part 3)

41.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the property valuation requirements described in chapter 41. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to market value and condition of the property.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on property valuation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

41.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the property valuation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to market value and condition of the property.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the property valuation activities in chapter 41.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

41.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for property valuation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 41.3: Stages and time limits - property valuation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

41.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the property valuation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving market value and condition of the property that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

41.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to property valuation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on property valuation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 41.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 41.5: Reporting calendar - property valuation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 42: Legal and title scrutiny (Part 3)

42.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the legal and title scrutiny requirements described in chapter 42. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and marketable title.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on legal and title scrutiny is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

42.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the legal and title scrutiny requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and marketable title.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the legal and title scrutiny activities in chapter 42.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

42.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for legal and title scrutiny is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 42.3: Stages and time limits - legal and title scrutiny

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

42.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the legal and title scrutiny requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and marketable title that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

42.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to legal and title scrutiny are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on legal and title scrutiny to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 42.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 42.5: Reporting calendar - legal and title scrutiny

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 43: KYC and anti-money-laundering checks (Part 3)

43.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements described in chapter 43. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to customer identity and source of funds.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

43.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to customer identity and source of funds.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks activities in chapter 43.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

43.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 43.3: Stages and time limits - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

43.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving customer identity and source of funds that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

43.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to kyc and anti-money-laundering checks are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 43.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 43.5: Reporting calendar - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 44: Loan documentation (Part 3)

44.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the loan documentation requirements described in chapter 44. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on loan documentation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

44.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the loan documentation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the loan documentation activities in chapter 44.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

44.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for loan documentation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 44.3: Stages and time limits - loan documentation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

44.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the loan documentation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving completeness and accuracy of signed documents that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

44.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to loan documentation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on loan documentation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 44.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 44.5: Reporting calendar - loan documentation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 45: Disbursement conditions (Part 3)

45.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the disbursement conditions requirements described in chapter 45. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on disbursement conditions is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

45.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the disbursement conditions requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the disbursement conditions activities in chapter 45.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

45.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for disbursement conditions is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 45.3: Stages and time limits - disbursement conditions

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

45.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the disbursement conditions requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving conditions to be met before funds are released that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

45.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to disbursement conditions are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on disbursement conditions to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 45.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 45.5: Reporting calendar - disbursement conditions

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 46: Collections and recovery (Part 3)

46.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the collections and recovery requirements described in chapter 46. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on collections and recovery is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

46.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the collections and recovery requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the collections and recovery activities in chapter 46.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

46.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for collections and recovery is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 46.3: Stages and time limits - collections and recovery

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

46.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the collections and recovery requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

46.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to collections and recovery are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on collections and recovery to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 46.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 46.5: Reporting calendar - collections and recovery

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 47: Customer grievance handling (Part 3)

47.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer grievance handling requirements described in chapter 47. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer grievance handling is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

47.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer grievance handling requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer grievance handling activities in chapter 47.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

47.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer grievance handling is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 47.3: Stages and time limits - customer grievance handling

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

47.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer grievance handling requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

47.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer grievance handling are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer grievance handling to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 47.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 47.5: Reporting calendar - customer grievance handling

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 48: Internal audit and compliance (Part 3)

48.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the internal audit and compliance requirements described in chapter 48. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on internal audit and compliance is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

48.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the internal audit and compliance requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the internal audit and compliance activities in chapter 48.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

48.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for internal audit and compliance is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 48.3: Stages and time limits - internal audit and compliance

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

48.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the internal audit and compliance requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

48.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to internal audit and compliance are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on internal audit and compliance to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 48.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 48.5: Reporting calendar - internal audit and compliance

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 49: Data privacy and record keeping (Part 3)

49.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the data privacy and record keeping requirements described in chapter 49. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to safe handling of personal information.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on data privacy and record keeping is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

49.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the data privacy and record keeping requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to safe handling of personal information.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the data privacy and record keeping activities in chapter 49.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

49.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for data privacy and record keeping is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 49.3: Stages and time limits - data privacy and record keeping

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

49.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the data privacy and record keeping requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving safe handling of personal information that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

49.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to data privacy and record keeping are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on data privacy and record keeping to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 49.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 49.5: Reporting calendar - data privacy and record keeping

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 50: Fraud monitoring (Part 3)

50.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the fraud monitoring requirements described in chapter 50. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on fraud monitoring is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

50.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the fraud monitoring requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the fraud monitoring activities in chapter 50.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

50.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for fraud monitoring is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 50.3: Stages and time limits - fraud monitoring

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

50.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the fraud monitoring requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving red-flag indicators and escalation that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

50.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to fraud monitoring are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on fraud monitoring to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 50.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 50.5: Reporting calendar - fraud monitoring

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 51: Customer communication (Part 3)

51.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer communication requirements described in chapter 51. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and timely communication to customers.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer communication is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

51.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer communication requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and timely communication to customers.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer communication activities in chapter 51.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

51.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer communication is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 51.3: Stages and time limits - customer communication

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

51.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer communication requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and timely communication to customers that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

51.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer communication are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer communication to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 51.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 51.5: Reporting calendar - customer communication

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 52: Staff training and certification (Part 3)

52.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the staff training and certification requirements described in chapter 52. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on staff training and certification is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

52.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the staff training and certification requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the staff training and certification activities in chapter 52.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

52.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for staff training and certification is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 52.3: Stages and time limits - staff training and certification

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

52.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the staff training and certification requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

52.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to staff training and certification are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on staff training and certification to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 52.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 52.5: Reporting calendar - staff training and certification

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 53: Credit appraisal (Part 4)

53.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the credit appraisal requirements described in chapter 53. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on credit appraisal is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

53.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the credit appraisal requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the credit appraisal activities in chapter 53.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

53.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for credit appraisal is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 53.3: Stages and time limits - credit appraisal

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

53.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the credit appraisal requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving repayment capacity and existing obligations that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

53.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to credit appraisal are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on credit appraisal to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 53.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 53.5: Reporting calendar - credit appraisal

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 54: Income assessment (Part 4)

54.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the income assessment requirements described in chapter 54. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to the stability and verifiability of income.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on income assessment is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

54.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the income assessment requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to the stability and verifiability of income.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the income assessment activities in chapter 54.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

54.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for income assessment is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 54.3: Stages and time limits - income assessment

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

54.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the income assessment requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving the stability and verifiability of income that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

54.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to income assessment are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on income assessment to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 54.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 54.5: Reporting calendar - income assessment

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 55: Property valuation (Part 4)

55.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the property valuation requirements described in chapter 55. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to market value and condition of the property.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on property valuation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

55.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the property valuation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to market value and condition of the property.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the property valuation activities in chapter 55.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

55.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for property valuation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 55.3: Stages and time limits - property valuation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

55.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the property valuation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving market value and condition of the property that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

55.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to property valuation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on property valuation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 55.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 55.5: Reporting calendar - property valuation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 56: Legal and title scrutiny (Part 4)

56.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the legal and title scrutiny requirements described in chapter 56. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and marketable title.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on legal and title scrutiny is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

56.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the legal and title scrutiny requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and marketable title.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the legal and title scrutiny activities in chapter 56.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

56.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for legal and title scrutiny is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 56.3: Stages and time limits - legal and title scrutiny

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

56.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the legal and title scrutiny requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and marketable title that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

56.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to legal and title scrutiny are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on legal and title scrutiny to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 56.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 56.5: Reporting calendar - legal and title scrutiny

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 57: KYC and anti-money-laundering checks (Part 4)

57.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements described in chapter 57. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to customer identity and source of funds.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

57.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to customer identity and source of funds.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks activities in chapter 57.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

57.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 57.3: Stages and time limits - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

57.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving customer identity and source of funds that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

57.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to kyc and anti-money-laundering checks are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 57.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 57.5: Reporting calendar - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 58: Loan documentation (Part 4)

58.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the loan documentation requirements described in chapter 58. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on loan documentation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

58.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the loan documentation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the loan documentation activities in chapter 58.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

58.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for loan documentation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 58.3: Stages and time limits - loan documentation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

58.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the loan documentation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving completeness and accuracy of signed documents that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

58.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to loan documentation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on loan documentation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 58.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 58.5: Reporting calendar - loan documentation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 59: Disbursement conditions (Part 4)

59.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the disbursement conditions requirements described in chapter 59. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on disbursement conditions is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

59.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the disbursement conditions requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the disbursement conditions activities in chapter 59.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

59.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for disbursement conditions is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 59.3: Stages and time limits - disbursement conditions

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

59.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the disbursement conditions requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving conditions to be met before funds are released that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

59.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to disbursement conditions are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on disbursement conditions to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 59.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 59.5: Reporting calendar - disbursement conditions

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 60: Collections and recovery (Part 4)

60.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the collections and recovery requirements described in chapter 60. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on collections and recovery is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

60.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the collections and recovery requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the collections and recovery activities in chapter 60.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

60.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for collections and recovery is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 60.3: Stages and time limits - collections and recovery

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

60.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the collections and recovery requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

60.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to collections and recovery are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on collections and recovery to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 60.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 60.5: Reporting calendar - collections and recovery

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 61: Customer grievance handling (Part 4)

61.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer grievance handling requirements described in chapter 61. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer grievance handling is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

61.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer grievance handling requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer grievance handling activities in chapter 61.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

61.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer grievance handling is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 61.3: Stages and time limits - customer grievance handling

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

61.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer grievance handling requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

61.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer grievance handling are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer grievance handling to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 61.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 61.5: Reporting calendar - customer grievance handling

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 62: Internal audit and compliance (Part 4)

62.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the internal audit and compliance requirements described in chapter 62. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on internal audit and compliance is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

62.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the internal audit and compliance requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the internal audit and compliance activities in chapter 62.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

62.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for internal audit and compliance is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 62.3: Stages and time limits - internal audit and compliance

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

62.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the internal audit and compliance requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

62.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to internal audit and compliance are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on internal audit and compliance to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 62.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 62.5: Reporting calendar - internal audit and compliance

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 63: Data privacy and record keeping (Part 4)

63.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the data privacy and record keeping requirements described in chapter 63. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to safe handling of personal information.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on data privacy and record keeping is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

63.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the data privacy and record keeping requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to safe handling of personal information.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the data privacy and record keeping activities in chapter 63.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

63.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for data privacy and record keeping is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 63.3: Stages and time limits - data privacy and record keeping

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

63.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the data privacy and record keeping requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving safe handling of personal information that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

63.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to data privacy and record keeping are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on data privacy and record keeping to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 63.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 63.5: Reporting calendar - data privacy and record keeping

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 64: Fraud monitoring (Part 4)

64.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the fraud monitoring requirements described in chapter 64. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on fraud monitoring is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

64.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the fraud monitoring requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the fraud monitoring activities in chapter 64.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

64.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for fraud monitoring is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 64.3: Stages and time limits - fraud monitoring

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

64.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the fraud monitoring requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving red-flag indicators and escalation that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

64.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to fraud monitoring are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on fraud monitoring to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 64.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 64.5: Reporting calendar - fraud monitoring

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 65: Customer communication (Part 4)

65.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer communication requirements described in chapter 65. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and timely communication to customers.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer communication is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

65.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer communication requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and timely communication to customers.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer communication activities in chapter 65.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

65.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer communication is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 65.3: Stages and time limits - customer communication

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

65.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer communication requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and timely communication to customers that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

65.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer communication are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer communication to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 65.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 65.5: Reporting calendar - customer communication

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 66: Staff training and certification (Part 4)

66.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the staff training and certification requirements described in chapter 66. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on staff training and certification is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

66.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the staff training and certification requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the staff training and certification activities in chapter 66.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

66.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for staff training and certification is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 66.3: Stages and time limits - staff training and certification

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

66.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the staff training and certification requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

66.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to staff training and certification are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on staff training and certification to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 66.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 66.5: Reporting calendar - staff training and certification

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 67: Credit appraisal (Part 5)

67.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the credit appraisal requirements described in chapter 67. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on credit appraisal is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

67.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the credit appraisal requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the credit appraisal activities in chapter 67.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

67.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for credit appraisal is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 67.3: Stages and time limits - credit appraisal

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

67.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the credit appraisal requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving repayment capacity and existing obligations that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

67.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to credit appraisal are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on credit appraisal to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 67.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 67.5: Reporting calendar - credit appraisal

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 68: Income assessment (Part 5)

68.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the income assessment requirements described in chapter 68. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to the stability and verifiability of income.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on income assessment is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

68.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the income assessment requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to the stability and verifiability of income.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the income assessment activities in chapter 68.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

68.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for income assessment is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 68.3: Stages and time limits - income assessment

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

68.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the income assessment requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving the stability and verifiability of income that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

68.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to income assessment are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on income assessment to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 68.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 68.5: Reporting calendar - income assessment

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 69: Property valuation (Part 5)

69.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the property valuation requirements described in chapter 69. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to market value and condition of the property.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on property valuation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

69.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the property valuation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to market value and condition of the property.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the property valuation activities in chapter 69.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

69.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for property valuation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 69.3: Stages and time limits - property valuation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

69.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the property valuation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving market value and condition of the property that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

69.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to property valuation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on property valuation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 69.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 69.5: Reporting calendar - property valuation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 70: Legal and title scrutiny (Part 5)

70.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the legal and title scrutiny requirements described in chapter 70. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and marketable title.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on legal and title scrutiny is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

70.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the legal and title scrutiny requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and marketable title.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the legal and title scrutiny activities in chapter 70.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

70.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for legal and title scrutiny is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 70.3: Stages and time limits - legal and title scrutiny

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

70.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the legal and title scrutiny requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and marketable title that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

70.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to legal and title scrutiny are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on legal and title scrutiny to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 70.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 70.5: Reporting calendar - legal and title scrutiny

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 71: KYC and anti-money-laundering checks (Part 5)

71.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements described in chapter 71. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to customer identity and source of funds.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

71.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to customer identity and source of funds.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks activities in chapter 71.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

71.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 71.3: Stages and time limits - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

71.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving customer identity and source of funds that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

71.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to kyc and anti-money-laundering checks are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 71.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 71.5: Reporting calendar - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 72: Loan documentation (Part 5)

72.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the loan documentation requirements described in chapter 72. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on loan documentation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

72.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the loan documentation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the loan documentation activities in chapter 72.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

72.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for loan documentation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 72.3: Stages and time limits - loan documentation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

72.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the loan documentation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving completeness and accuracy of signed documents that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

72.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to loan documentation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on loan documentation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 72.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 72.5: Reporting calendar - loan documentation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 73: Disbursement conditions (Part 5)

73.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the disbursement conditions requirements described in chapter 73. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on disbursement conditions is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

73.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the disbursement conditions requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the disbursement conditions activities in chapter 73.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

73.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for disbursement conditions is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 73.3: Stages and time limits - disbursement conditions

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

73.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the disbursement conditions requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving conditions to be met before funds are released that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

73.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to disbursement conditions are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on disbursement conditions to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 73.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 73.5: Reporting calendar - disbursement conditions

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 74: Collections and recovery (Part 5)

74.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the collections and recovery requirements described in chapter 74. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on collections and recovery is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

74.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the collections and recovery requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the collections and recovery activities in chapter 74.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

74.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for collections and recovery is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 74.3: Stages and time limits - collections and recovery

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

74.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the collections and recovery requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

74.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to collections and recovery are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on collections and recovery to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 74.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 74.5: Reporting calendar - collections and recovery

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 75: Customer grievance handling (Part 5)

75.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer grievance handling requirements described in chapter 75. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer grievance handling is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

75.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer grievance handling requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer grievance handling activities in chapter 75.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

75.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer grievance handling is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 75.3: Stages and time limits - customer grievance handling

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

75.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer grievance handling requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

75.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer grievance handling are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer grievance handling to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 75.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 75.5: Reporting calendar - customer grievance handling

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 76: Internal audit and compliance (Part 5)

76.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the internal audit and compliance requirements described in chapter 76. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on internal audit and compliance is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

76.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the internal audit and compliance requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the internal audit and compliance activities in chapter 76.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

76.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for internal audit and compliance is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 76.3: Stages and time limits - internal audit and compliance

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

76.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the internal audit and compliance requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

76.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to internal audit and compliance are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on internal audit and compliance to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 76.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 76.5: Reporting calendar - internal audit and compliance

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 77: Data privacy and record keeping (Part 5)

77.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the data privacy and record keeping requirements described in chapter 77. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to safe handling of personal information.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on data privacy and record keeping is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

77.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the data privacy and record keeping requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to safe handling of personal information.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the data privacy and record keeping activities in chapter 77.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

77.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for data privacy and record keeping is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 77.3: Stages and time limits - data privacy and record keeping

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

77.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the data privacy and record keeping requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving safe handling of personal information that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

77.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to data privacy and record keeping are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on data privacy and record keeping to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 77.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 77.5: Reporting calendar - data privacy and record keeping

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 78: Fraud monitoring (Part 5)

78.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the fraud monitoring requirements described in chapter 78. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on fraud monitoring is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

78.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the fraud monitoring requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the fraud monitoring activities in chapter 78.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

78.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for fraud monitoring is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 78.3: Stages and time limits - fraud monitoring

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

78.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the fraud monitoring requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving red-flag indicators and escalation that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

78.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to fraud monitoring are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on fraud monitoring to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 78.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 78.5: Reporting calendar - fraud monitoring

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 79: Customer communication (Part 5)

79.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer communication requirements described in chapter 79. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and timely communication to customers.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer communication is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

79.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer communication requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and timely communication to customers.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer communication activities in chapter 79.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

79.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer communication is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 79.3: Stages and time limits - customer communication

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

79.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer communication requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and timely communication to customers that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

79.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer communication are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer communication to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 79.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 79.5: Reporting calendar - customer communication

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 80: Staff training and certification (Part 5)

80.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the staff training and certification requirements described in chapter 80. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on staff training and certification is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

80.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the staff training and certification requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the staff training and certification activities in chapter 80.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

80.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for staff training and certification is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 80.3: Stages and time limits - staff training and certification

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

80.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the staff training and certification requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

80.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to staff training and certification are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on staff training and certification to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 80.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 80.5: Reporting calendar - staff training and certification

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 81: Credit appraisal (Part 6)

81.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the credit appraisal requirements described in chapter 81. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on credit appraisal is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

81.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the credit appraisal requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the credit appraisal activities in chapter 81.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

81.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for credit appraisal is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 81.3: Stages and time limits - credit appraisal

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

81.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the credit appraisal requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving repayment capacity and existing obligations that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

81.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to credit appraisal are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on credit appraisal to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 81.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 81.5: Reporting calendar - credit appraisal

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 82: Income assessment (Part 6)

82.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the income assessment requirements described in chapter 82. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to the stability and verifiability of income.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on income assessment is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

82.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the income assessment requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to the stability and verifiability of income.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the income assessment activities in chapter 82.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

82.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for income assessment is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 82.3: Stages and time limits - income assessment

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

82.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the income assessment requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving the stability and verifiability of income that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

82.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to income assessment are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on income assessment to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 82.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 82.5: Reporting calendar - income assessment

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 83: Property valuation (Part 6)

83.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the property valuation requirements described in chapter 83. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to market value and condition of the property.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on property valuation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

83.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the property valuation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to market value and condition of the property.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the property valuation activities in chapter 83.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

83.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for property valuation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 83.3: Stages and time limits - property valuation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

83.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the property valuation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving market value and condition of the property that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

83.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to property valuation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on property valuation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 83.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 83.5: Reporting calendar - property valuation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 84: Legal and title scrutiny (Part 6)

84.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the legal and title scrutiny requirements described in chapter 84. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and marketable title.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on legal and title scrutiny is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

84.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the legal and title scrutiny requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and marketable title.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the legal and title scrutiny activities in chapter 84.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

84.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for legal and title scrutiny is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 84.3: Stages and time limits - legal and title scrutiny

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

84.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the legal and title scrutiny requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and marketable title that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

84.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to legal and title scrutiny are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on legal and title scrutiny to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 84.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 84.5: Reporting calendar - legal and title scrutiny

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 85: KYC and anti-money-laundering checks (Part 6)

85.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements described in chapter 85. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to customer identity and source of funds.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

85.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to customer identity and source of funds.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks activities in chapter 85.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

85.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 85.3: Stages and time limits - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

85.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving customer identity and source of funds that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

85.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to kyc and anti-money-laundering checks are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 85.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 85.5: Reporting calendar - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 86: Loan documentation (Part 6)

86.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the loan documentation requirements described in chapter 86. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on loan documentation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

86.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the loan documentation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the loan documentation activities in chapter 86.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

86.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for loan documentation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 86.3: Stages and time limits - loan documentation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

86.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the loan documentation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving completeness and accuracy of signed documents that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

86.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to loan documentation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on loan documentation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 86.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 86.5: Reporting calendar - loan documentation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 87: Disbursement conditions (Part 6)

87.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the disbursement conditions requirements described in chapter 87. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on disbursement conditions is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

87.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the disbursement conditions requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the disbursement conditions activities in chapter 87.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

87.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for disbursement conditions is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 87.3: Stages and time limits - disbursement conditions

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

87.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the disbursement conditions requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving conditions to be met before funds are released that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

87.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to disbursement conditions are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on disbursement conditions to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 87.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 87.5: Reporting calendar - disbursement conditions

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 88: Collections and recovery (Part 6)

88.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the collections and recovery requirements described in chapter 88. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on collections and recovery is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

88.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the collections and recovery requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the collections and recovery activities in chapter 88.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

88.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for collections and recovery is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 88.3: Stages and time limits - collections and recovery

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

88.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the collections and recovery requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

88.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to collections and recovery are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on collections and recovery to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 88.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 88.5: Reporting calendar - collections and recovery

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 89: Customer grievance handling (Part 6)

89.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer grievance handling requirements described in chapter 89. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer grievance handling is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

89.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer grievance handling requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer grievance handling activities in chapter 89.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

89.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer grievance handling is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 89.3: Stages and time limits - customer grievance handling

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

89.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer grievance handling requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

89.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer grievance handling are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer grievance handling to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 89.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 89.5: Reporting calendar - customer grievance handling

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 90: Internal audit and compliance (Part 6)

90.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the internal audit and compliance requirements described in chapter 90. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on internal audit and compliance is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

90.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the internal audit and compliance requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the internal audit and compliance activities in chapter 90.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

90.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for internal audit and compliance is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 90.3: Stages and time limits - internal audit and compliance

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

90.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the internal audit and compliance requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

90.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to internal audit and compliance are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on internal audit and compliance to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 90.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 90.5: Reporting calendar - internal audit and compliance

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 91: Data privacy and record keeping (Part 6)

91.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the data privacy and record keeping requirements described in chapter 91. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to safe handling of personal information.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on data privacy and record keeping is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

91.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the data privacy and record keeping requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to safe handling of personal information.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the data privacy and record keeping activities in chapter 91.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

91.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for data privacy and record keeping is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 91.3: Stages and time limits - data privacy and record keeping

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

91.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the data privacy and record keeping requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving safe handling of personal information that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

91.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to data privacy and record keeping are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on data privacy and record keeping to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 91.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 91.5: Reporting calendar - data privacy and record keeping

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 92: Fraud monitoring (Part 6)

92.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the fraud monitoring requirements described in chapter 92. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on fraud monitoring is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

92.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the fraud monitoring requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the fraud monitoring activities in chapter 92.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

92.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for fraud monitoring is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 92.3: Stages and time limits - fraud monitoring

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

92.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the fraud monitoring requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving red-flag indicators and escalation that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

92.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to fraud monitoring are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on fraud monitoring to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 92.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 92.5: Reporting calendar - fraud monitoring

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 93: Customer communication (Part 6)

93.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer communication requirements described in chapter 93. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and timely communication to customers.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer communication is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

93.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer communication requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and timely communication to customers.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer communication activities in chapter 93.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

93.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer communication is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 93.3: Stages and time limits - customer communication

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

93.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer communication requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and timely communication to customers that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

93.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer communication are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer communication to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 93.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 93.5: Reporting calendar - customer communication

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 94: Staff training and certification (Part 6)

94.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the staff training and certification requirements described in chapter 94. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on staff training and certification is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

94.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the staff training and certification requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the staff training and certification activities in chapter 94.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

94.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for staff training and certification is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 94.3: Stages and time limits - staff training and certification

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

94.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the staff training and certification requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

94.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to staff training and certification are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on staff training and certification to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 94.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 94.5: Reporting calendar - staff training and certification

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 95: Credit appraisal (Part 7)

95.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the credit appraisal requirements described in chapter 95. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on credit appraisal is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

95.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the credit appraisal requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the credit appraisal activities in chapter 95.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

95.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for credit appraisal is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 95.3: Stages and time limits - credit appraisal

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

95.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the credit appraisal requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving repayment capacity and existing obligations that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

95.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to credit appraisal are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on credit appraisal to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 95.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 95.5: Reporting calendar - credit appraisal

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 96: Income assessment (Part 7)

96.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the income assessment requirements described in chapter 96. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to the stability and verifiability of income.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on income assessment is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

96.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the income assessment requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to the stability and verifiability of income.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the income assessment activities in chapter 96.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

96.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for income assessment is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 96.3: Stages and time limits - income assessment

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

96.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the income assessment requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving the stability and verifiability of income that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

96.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to income assessment are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on income assessment to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 96.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 96.5: Reporting calendar - income assessment

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 97: Property valuation (Part 7)

97.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the property valuation requirements described in chapter 97. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to market value and condition of the property.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on property valuation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

97.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the property valuation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to market value and condition of the property.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the property valuation activities in chapter 97.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

97.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for property valuation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 97.3: Stages and time limits - property valuation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

97.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the property valuation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving market value and condition of the property that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

97.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to property valuation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on property valuation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 97.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 97.5: Reporting calendar - property valuation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 98: Legal and title scrutiny (Part 7)

98.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the legal and title scrutiny requirements described in chapter 98. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and marketable title.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on legal and title scrutiny is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

98.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the legal and title scrutiny requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and marketable title.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the legal and title scrutiny activities in chapter 98.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

98.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for legal and title scrutiny is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 98.3: Stages and time limits - legal and title scrutiny

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

98.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the legal and title scrutiny requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and marketable title that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

98.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to legal and title scrutiny are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on legal and title scrutiny to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 98.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 98.5: Reporting calendar - legal and title scrutiny

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 99: KYC and anti-money-laundering checks (Part 7)

99.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements described in chapter 99. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to customer identity and source of funds.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

99.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to customer identity and source of funds.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks activities in chapter 99.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

99.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 99.3: Stages and time limits - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

99.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving customer identity and source of funds that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

99.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to kyc and anti-money-laundering checks are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 99.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 99.5: Reporting calendar - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 100: Loan documentation (Part 7)

100.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the loan documentation requirements described in chapter 100. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on loan documentation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

100.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the loan documentation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the loan documentation activities in chapter 100.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

100.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for loan documentation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 100.3: Stages and time limits - loan documentation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

100.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the loan documentation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving completeness and accuracy of signed documents that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

100.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to loan documentation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on loan documentation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 100.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 100.5: Reporting calendar - loan documentation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 101: Disbursement conditions (Part 7)

101.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the disbursement conditions requirements described in chapter 101. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on disbursement conditions is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

101.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the disbursement conditions requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the disbursement conditions activities in chapter 101.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

101.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for disbursement conditions is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 101.3: Stages and time limits - disbursement conditions

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

101.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the disbursement conditions requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving conditions to be met before funds are released that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

101.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to disbursement conditions are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on disbursement conditions to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 101.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 101.5: Reporting calendar - disbursement conditions

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 102: Collections and recovery (Part 7)

102.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the collections and recovery requirements described in chapter 102. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on collections and recovery is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

102.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the collections and recovery requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the collections and recovery activities in chapter 102.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

102.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for collections and recovery is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 102.3: Stages and time limits - collections and recovery

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

102.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the collections and recovery requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

102.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to collections and recovery are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on collections and recovery to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 102.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 102.5: Reporting calendar - collections and recovery

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 103: Customer grievance handling (Part 7)

103.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer grievance handling requirements described in chapter 103. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer grievance handling is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

103.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer grievance handling requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer grievance handling activities in chapter 103.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

103.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer grievance handling is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 103.3: Stages and time limits - customer grievance handling

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

103.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer grievance handling requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

103.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer grievance handling are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer grievance handling to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 103.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 103.5: Reporting calendar - customer grievance handling

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 104: Internal audit and compliance (Part 7)

104.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the internal audit and compliance requirements described in chapter 104. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on internal audit and compliance is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

104.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the internal audit and compliance requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the internal audit and compliance activities in chapter 104.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

104.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for internal audit and compliance is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 104.3: Stages and time limits - internal audit and compliance

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

104.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the internal audit and compliance requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

104.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to internal audit and compliance are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on internal audit and compliance to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 104.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 104.5: Reporting calendar - internal audit and compliance

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 105: Data privacy and record keeping (Part 7)

105.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the data privacy and record keeping requirements described in chapter 105. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to safe handling of personal information.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on data privacy and record keeping is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

105.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the data privacy and record keeping requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to safe handling of personal information.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the data privacy and record keeping activities in chapter 105.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

105.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for data privacy and record keeping is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 105.3: Stages and time limits - data privacy and record keeping

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

105.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the data privacy and record keeping requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving safe handling of personal information that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

105.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to data privacy and record keeping are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on data privacy and record keeping to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 105.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 105.5: Reporting calendar - data privacy and record keeping

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 106: Fraud monitoring (Part 7)

106.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the fraud monitoring requirements described in chapter 106. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on fraud monitoring is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

106.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the fraud monitoring requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the fraud monitoring activities in chapter 106.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

106.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for fraud monitoring is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 106.3: Stages and time limits - fraud monitoring

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

106.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the fraud monitoring requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving red-flag indicators and escalation that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

106.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to fraud monitoring are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on fraud monitoring to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 106.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 106.5: Reporting calendar - fraud monitoring

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 107: Customer communication (Part 7)

107.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer communication requirements described in chapter 107. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and timely communication to customers.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer communication is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

107.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer communication requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and timely communication to customers.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer communication activities in chapter 107.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

107.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer communication is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 107.3: Stages and time limits - customer communication

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

107.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer communication requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and timely communication to customers that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

107.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer communication are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer communication to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 107.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 107.5: Reporting calendar - customer communication

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 108: Staff training and certification (Part 7)

108.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the staff training and certification requirements described in chapter 108. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on staff training and certification is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

108.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the staff training and certification requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the staff training and certification activities in chapter 108.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

108.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for staff training and certification is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 108.3: Stages and time limits - staff training and certification

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

108.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the staff training and certification requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

108.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to staff training and certification are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on staff training and certification to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 108.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 108.5: Reporting calendar - staff training and certification

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 109: Credit appraisal (Part 8)

109.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the credit appraisal requirements described in chapter 109. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on credit appraisal is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

109.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the credit appraisal requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the credit appraisal activities in chapter 109.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

109.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for credit appraisal is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 109.3: Stages and time limits - credit appraisal

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

109.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the credit appraisal requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving repayment capacity and existing obligations that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

109.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to credit appraisal are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on credit appraisal to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 109.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 109.5: Reporting calendar - credit appraisal

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 110: Income assessment (Part 8)

110.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the income assessment requirements described in chapter 110. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to the stability and verifiability of income.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on income assessment is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

110.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the income assessment requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to the stability and verifiability of income.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the income assessment activities in chapter 110.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

110.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for income assessment is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 110.3: Stages and time limits - income assessment

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

110.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the income assessment requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving the stability and verifiability of income that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

110.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to income assessment are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on income assessment to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 110.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 110.5: Reporting calendar - income assessment

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 111: Property valuation (Part 8)

111.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the property valuation requirements described in chapter 111. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to market value and condition of the property.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on property valuation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

111.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the property valuation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to market value and condition of the property.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the property valuation activities in chapter 111.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

111.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for property valuation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 111.3: Stages and time limits - property valuation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

111.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the property valuation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving market value and condition of the property that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

111.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to property valuation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on property valuation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 111.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 111.5: Reporting calendar - property valuation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 112: Legal and title scrutiny (Part 8)

112.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the legal and title scrutiny requirements described in chapter 112. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and marketable title.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on legal and title scrutiny is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

112.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the legal and title scrutiny requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and marketable title.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the legal and title scrutiny activities in chapter 112.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

112.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for legal and title scrutiny is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 112.3: Stages and time limits - legal and title scrutiny

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

112.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the legal and title scrutiny requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and marketable title that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

112.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to legal and title scrutiny are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on legal and title scrutiny to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 112.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 112.5: Reporting calendar - legal and title scrutiny

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 113: KYC and anti-money-laundering checks (Part 8)

113.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements described in chapter 113. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to customer identity and source of funds.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

113.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to customer identity and source of funds.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks activities in chapter 113.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

113.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 113.3: Stages and time limits - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

113.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving customer identity and source of funds that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

113.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to kyc and anti-money-laundering checks are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 113.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 113.5: Reporting calendar - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 114: Loan documentation (Part 8)

114.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the loan documentation requirements described in chapter 114. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on loan documentation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

114.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the loan documentation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the loan documentation activities in chapter 114.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

114.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for loan documentation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 114.3: Stages and time limits - loan documentation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

114.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the loan documentation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving completeness and accuracy of signed documents that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

114.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to loan documentation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on loan documentation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 114.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 114.5: Reporting calendar - loan documentation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 115: Disbursement conditions (Part 8)

115.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the disbursement conditions requirements described in chapter 115. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on disbursement conditions is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

115.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the disbursement conditions requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the disbursement conditions activities in chapter 115.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

115.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for disbursement conditions is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 115.3: Stages and time limits - disbursement conditions

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

115.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the disbursement conditions requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving conditions to be met before funds are released that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

115.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to disbursement conditions are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on disbursement conditions to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 115.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 115.5: Reporting calendar - disbursement conditions

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 116: Collections and recovery (Part 8)

116.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the collections and recovery requirements described in chapter 116. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on collections and recovery is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

116.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the collections and recovery requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the collections and recovery activities in chapter 116.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

116.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for collections and recovery is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 116.3: Stages and time limits - collections and recovery

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

116.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the collections and recovery requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

116.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to collections and recovery are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on collections and recovery to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 116.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 116.5: Reporting calendar - collections and recovery

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 117: Customer grievance handling (Part 8)

117.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer grievance handling requirements described in chapter 117. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer grievance handling is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

117.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer grievance handling requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer grievance handling activities in chapter 117.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

117.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer grievance handling is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 117.3: Stages and time limits - customer grievance handling

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

117.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer grievance handling requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

117.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer grievance handling are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer grievance handling to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 117.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 117.5: Reporting calendar - customer grievance handling

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 118: Internal audit and compliance (Part 8)

118.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the internal audit and compliance requirements described in chapter 118. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on internal audit and compliance is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

118.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the internal audit and compliance requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the internal audit and compliance activities in chapter 118.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

118.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for internal audit and compliance is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 118.3: Stages and time limits - internal audit and compliance

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

118.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the internal audit and compliance requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

118.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to internal audit and compliance are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on internal audit and compliance to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 118.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 118.5: Reporting calendar - internal audit and compliance

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 119: Data privacy and record keeping (Part 8)

119.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the data privacy and record keeping requirements described in chapter 119. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to safe handling of personal information.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on data privacy and record keeping is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

119.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the data privacy and record keeping requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to safe handling of personal information.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the data privacy and record keeping activities in chapter 119.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

119.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for data privacy and record keeping is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 119.3: Stages and time limits - data privacy and record keeping

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

119.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the data privacy and record keeping requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving safe handling of personal information that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

119.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to data privacy and record keeping are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on data privacy and record keeping to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 119.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 119.5: Reporting calendar - data privacy and record keeping

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 120: Fraud monitoring (Part 8)

120.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the fraud monitoring requirements described in chapter 120. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on fraud monitoring is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

120.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the fraud monitoring requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the fraud monitoring activities in chapter 120.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

120.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for fraud monitoring is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 120.3: Stages and time limits - fraud monitoring

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

120.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the fraud monitoring requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving red-flag indicators and escalation that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

120.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to fraud monitoring are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on fraud monitoring to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 120.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 120.5: Reporting calendar - fraud monitoring

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 121: Customer communication (Part 8)

121.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer communication requirements described in chapter 121. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and timely communication to customers.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer communication is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

121.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer communication requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and timely communication to customers.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer communication activities in chapter 121.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

121.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer communication is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 121.3: Stages and time limits - customer communication

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

121.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer communication requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and timely communication to customers that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

121.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer communication are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer communication to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 121.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 121.5: Reporting calendar - customer communication

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 122: Staff training and certification (Part 8)

122.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the staff training and certification requirements described in chapter 122. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on staff training and certification is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

122.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the staff training and certification requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the staff training and certification activities in chapter 122.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

122.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for staff training and certification is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 122.3: Stages and time limits - staff training and certification

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

122.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the staff training and certification requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

122.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to staff training and certification are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on staff training and certification to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 122.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 122.5: Reporting calendar - staff training and certification

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 123: Credit appraisal (Part 9)

123.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the credit appraisal requirements described in chapter 123. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on credit appraisal is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

123.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the credit appraisal requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the credit appraisal activities in chapter 123.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

123.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for credit appraisal is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 123.3: Stages and time limits - credit appraisal

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

123.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the credit appraisal requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving repayment capacity and existing obligations that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

123.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to credit appraisal are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on credit appraisal to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 123.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 123.5: Reporting calendar - credit appraisal

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 124: Income assessment (Part 9)

124.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the income assessment requirements described in chapter 124. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to the stability and verifiability of income.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on income assessment is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

124.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the income assessment requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to the stability and verifiability of income.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the income assessment activities in chapter 124.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

124.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for income assessment is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 124.3: Stages and time limits - income assessment

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

124.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the income assessment requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving the stability and verifiability of income that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

124.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to income assessment are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on income assessment to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 124.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 124.5: Reporting calendar - income assessment

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 125: Property valuation (Part 9)

125.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the property valuation requirements described in chapter 125. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to market value and condition of the property.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on property valuation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

125.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the property valuation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to market value and condition of the property.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the property valuation activities in chapter 125.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

125.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for property valuation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 125.3: Stages and time limits - property valuation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

125.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the property valuation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving market value and condition of the property that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

125.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to property valuation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on property valuation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 125.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 125.5: Reporting calendar - property valuation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 126: Legal and title scrutiny (Part 9)

126.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the legal and title scrutiny requirements described in chapter 126. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and marketable title.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on legal and title scrutiny is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

126.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the legal and title scrutiny requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and marketable title.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the legal and title scrutiny activities in chapter 126.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

126.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for legal and title scrutiny is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 126.3: Stages and time limits - legal and title scrutiny

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

126.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the legal and title scrutiny requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and marketable title that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

126.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to legal and title scrutiny are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on legal and title scrutiny to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 126.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 126.5: Reporting calendar - legal and title scrutiny

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 127: KYC and anti-money-laundering checks (Part 9)

127.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements described in chapter 127. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to customer identity and source of funds.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

127.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to customer identity and source of funds.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks activities in chapter 127.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

127.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 127.3: Stages and time limits - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

127.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving customer identity and source of funds that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

127.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to kyc and anti-money-laundering checks are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 127.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 127.5: Reporting calendar - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 128: Loan documentation (Part 9)

128.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the loan documentation requirements described in chapter 128. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on loan documentation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

128.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the loan documentation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the loan documentation activities in chapter 128.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

128.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for loan documentation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 128.3: Stages and time limits - loan documentation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

128.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the loan documentation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving completeness and accuracy of signed documents that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

128.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to loan documentation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on loan documentation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 128.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 128.5: Reporting calendar - loan documentation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 129: Disbursement conditions (Part 9)

129.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the disbursement conditions requirements described in chapter 129. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on disbursement conditions is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

129.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the disbursement conditions requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the disbursement conditions activities in chapter 129.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

129.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for disbursement conditions is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 129.3: Stages and time limits - disbursement conditions

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

129.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the disbursement conditions requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving conditions to be met before funds are released that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

129.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to disbursement conditions are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on disbursement conditions to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 129.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 129.5: Reporting calendar - disbursement conditions

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 130: Collections and recovery (Part 9)

130.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the collections and recovery requirements described in chapter 130. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on collections and recovery is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

130.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the collections and recovery requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the collections and recovery activities in chapter 130.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

130.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for collections and recovery is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 130.3: Stages and time limits - collections and recovery

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

130.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the collections and recovery requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

130.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to collections and recovery are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on collections and recovery to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 130.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 130.5: Reporting calendar - collections and recovery

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 131: Customer grievance handling (Part 9)

131.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer grievance handling requirements described in chapter 131. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer grievance handling is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

131.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer grievance handling requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer grievance handling activities in chapter 131.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

131.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer grievance handling is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 131.3: Stages and time limits - customer grievance handling

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

131.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer grievance handling requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

131.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer grievance handling are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer grievance handling to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 131.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 131.5: Reporting calendar - customer grievance handling

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 132: Internal audit and compliance (Part 9)

132.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the internal audit and compliance requirements described in chapter 132. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on internal audit and compliance is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

132.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the internal audit and compliance requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the internal audit and compliance activities in chapter 132.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

132.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for internal audit and compliance is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 132.3: Stages and time limits - internal audit and compliance

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

132.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the internal audit and compliance requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

132.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to internal audit and compliance are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on internal audit and compliance to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 132.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 132.5: Reporting calendar - internal audit and compliance

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 133: Data privacy and record keeping (Part 9)

133.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the data privacy and record keeping requirements described in chapter 133. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to safe handling of personal information.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on data privacy and record keeping is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

133.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the data privacy and record keeping requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to safe handling of personal information.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the data privacy and record keeping activities in chapter 133.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

133.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for data privacy and record keeping is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 133.3: Stages and time limits - data privacy and record keeping

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

133.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the data privacy and record keeping requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving safe handling of personal information that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

133.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to data privacy and record keeping are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on data privacy and record keeping to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 133.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 133.5: Reporting calendar - data privacy and record keeping

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 134: Fraud monitoring (Part 9)

134.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the fraud monitoring requirements described in chapter 134. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on fraud monitoring is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

134.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the fraud monitoring requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the fraud monitoring activities in chapter 134.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

134.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for fraud monitoring is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 134.3: Stages and time limits - fraud monitoring

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

134.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the fraud monitoring requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving red-flag indicators and escalation that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

134.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to fraud monitoring are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on fraud monitoring to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 134.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 134.5: Reporting calendar - fraud monitoring

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 135: Customer communication (Part 9)

135.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer communication requirements described in chapter 135. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and timely communication to customers.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer communication is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

135.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer communication requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and timely communication to customers.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer communication activities in chapter 135.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

135.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer communication is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 135.3: Stages and time limits - customer communication

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

135.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer communication requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and timely communication to customers that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

135.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer communication are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer communication to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 135.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 135.5: Reporting calendar - customer communication

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 136: Staff training and certification (Part 9)

136.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the staff training and certification requirements described in chapter 136. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on staff training and certification is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

136.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the staff training and certification requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the staff training and certification activities in chapter 136.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

136.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for staff training and certification is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 136.3: Stages and time limits - staff training and certification

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

136.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the staff training and certification requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

136.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to staff training and certification are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on staff training and certification to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 136.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 136.5: Reporting calendar - staff training and certification

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 137: Credit appraisal (Part 10)

137.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the credit appraisal requirements described in chapter 137. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on credit appraisal is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

137.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the credit appraisal requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the credit appraisal activities in chapter 137.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

137.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for credit appraisal is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 137.3: Stages and time limits - credit appraisal

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

137.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the credit appraisal requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving repayment capacity and existing obligations that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

137.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to credit appraisal are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on credit appraisal to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 137.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 137.5: Reporting calendar - credit appraisal

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 138: Income assessment (Part 10)

138.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the income assessment requirements described in chapter 138. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to the stability and verifiability of income.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on income assessment is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

138.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the income assessment requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to the stability and verifiability of income.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the income assessment activities in chapter 138.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

138.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for income assessment is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 138.3: Stages and time limits - income assessment

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

138.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the income assessment requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving the stability and verifiability of income that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

138.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to income assessment are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on income assessment to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 138.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 138.5: Reporting calendar - income assessment

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 139: Property valuation (Part 10)

139.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the property valuation requirements described in chapter 139. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to market value and condition of the property.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on property valuation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

139.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the property valuation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to market value and condition of the property.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the property valuation activities in chapter 139.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

139.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for property valuation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 139.3: Stages and time limits - property valuation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

139.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the property valuation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving market value and condition of the property that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

139.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to property valuation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on property valuation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 139.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 139.5: Reporting calendar - property valuation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 140: Legal and title scrutiny (Part 10)

140.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the legal and title scrutiny requirements described in chapter 140. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and marketable title.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on legal and title scrutiny is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

140.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the legal and title scrutiny requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and marketable title.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the legal and title scrutiny activities in chapter 140.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

140.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for legal and title scrutiny is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 140.3: Stages and time limits - legal and title scrutiny

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

140.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the legal and title scrutiny requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and marketable title that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

140.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to legal and title scrutiny are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on legal and title scrutiny to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 140.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 140.5: Reporting calendar - legal and title scrutiny

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 141: KYC and anti-money-laundering checks (Part 10)

141.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements described in chapter 141. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to customer identity and source of funds.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

141.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to customer identity and source of funds.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks activities in chapter 141.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

141.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 141.3: Stages and time limits - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

141.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving customer identity and source of funds that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

141.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to kyc and anti-money-laundering checks are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 141.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 141.5: Reporting calendar - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 142: Loan documentation (Part 10)

142.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the loan documentation requirements described in chapter 142. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on loan documentation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

142.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the loan documentation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the loan documentation activities in chapter 142.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

142.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for loan documentation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 142.3: Stages and time limits - loan documentation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

142.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the loan documentation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving completeness and accuracy of signed documents that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

142.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to loan documentation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on loan documentation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 142.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 142.5: Reporting calendar - loan documentation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 143: Disbursement conditions (Part 10)

143.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the disbursement conditions requirements described in chapter 143. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on disbursement conditions is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

143.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the disbursement conditions requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the disbursement conditions activities in chapter 143.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

143.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for disbursement conditions is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 143.3: Stages and time limits - disbursement conditions

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

143.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the disbursement conditions requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving conditions to be met before funds are released that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

143.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to disbursement conditions are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on disbursement conditions to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 143.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 143.5: Reporting calendar - disbursement conditions

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 144: Collections and recovery (Part 10)

144.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the collections and recovery requirements described in chapter 144. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on collections and recovery is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

144.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the collections and recovery requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the collections and recovery activities in chapter 144.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

144.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for collections and recovery is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 144.3: Stages and time limits - collections and recovery

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

144.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the collections and recovery requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

144.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to collections and recovery are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on collections and recovery to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 144.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 144.5: Reporting calendar - collections and recovery

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 145: Customer grievance handling (Part 10)

145.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer grievance handling requirements described in chapter 145. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer grievance handling is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

145.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer grievance handling requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer grievance handling activities in chapter 145.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

145.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer grievance handling is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 145.3: Stages and time limits - customer grievance handling

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

145.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer grievance handling requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

145.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer grievance handling are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer grievance handling to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 145.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 145.5: Reporting calendar - customer grievance handling

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 146: Internal audit and compliance (Part 10)

146.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the internal audit and compliance requirements described in chapter 146. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on internal audit and compliance is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

146.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the internal audit and compliance requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the internal audit and compliance activities in chapter 146.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

146.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for internal audit and compliance is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 146.3: Stages and time limits - internal audit and compliance

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

146.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the internal audit and compliance requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

146.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to internal audit and compliance are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on internal audit and compliance to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 146.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 146.5: Reporting calendar - internal audit and compliance

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 147: Data privacy and record keeping (Part 10)

147.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the data privacy and record keeping requirements described in chapter 147. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to safe handling of personal information.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on data privacy and record keeping is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

147.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the data privacy and record keeping requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to safe handling of personal information.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the data privacy and record keeping activities in chapter 147.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

147.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for data privacy and record keeping is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 147.3: Stages and time limits - data privacy and record keeping

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

147.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the data privacy and record keeping requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving safe handling of personal information that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

147.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to data privacy and record keeping are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on data privacy and record keeping to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 147.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 147.5: Reporting calendar - data privacy and record keeping

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 148: Fraud monitoring (Part 10)

148.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the fraud monitoring requirements described in chapter 148. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on fraud monitoring is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

148.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the fraud monitoring requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the fraud monitoring activities in chapter 148.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

148.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for fraud monitoring is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 148.3: Stages and time limits - fraud monitoring

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

148.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the fraud monitoring requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving red-flag indicators and escalation that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

148.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to fraud monitoring are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on fraud monitoring to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 148.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 148.5: Reporting calendar - fraud monitoring

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 149: Customer communication (Part 10)

149.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer communication requirements described in chapter 149. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and timely communication to customers.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer communication is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

149.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer communication requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and timely communication to customers.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer communication activities in chapter 149.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

149.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer communication is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 149.3: Stages and time limits - customer communication

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

149.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer communication requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and timely communication to customers that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

149.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer communication are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer communication to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 149.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 149.5: Reporting calendar - customer communication

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 150: Staff training and certification (Part 10)

150.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the staff training and certification requirements described in chapter 150. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on staff training and certification is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

150.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the staff training and certification requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the staff training and certification activities in chapter 150.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

150.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for staff training and certification is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 150.3: Stages and time limits - staff training and certification

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

150.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the staff training and certification requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

150.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to staff training and certification are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on staff training and certification to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 150.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 150.5: Reporting calendar - staff training and certification

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 151: Credit appraisal (Part 11)

151.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the credit appraisal requirements described in chapter 151. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on credit appraisal is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

151.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the credit appraisal requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the credit appraisal activities in chapter 151.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

151.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for credit appraisal is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 151.3: Stages and time limits - credit appraisal

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

151.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the credit appraisal requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving repayment capacity and existing obligations that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

151.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to credit appraisal are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on credit appraisal to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 151.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 151.5: Reporting calendar - credit appraisal

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 152: Income assessment (Part 11)

152.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the income assessment requirements described in chapter 152. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to the stability and verifiability of income.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on income assessment is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

152.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the income assessment requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to the stability and verifiability of income.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the income assessment activities in chapter 152.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

152.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for income assessment is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 152.3: Stages and time limits - income assessment

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

152.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the income assessment requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving the stability and verifiability of income that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

152.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to income assessment are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on income assessment to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 152.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 152.5: Reporting calendar - income assessment

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 153: Property valuation (Part 11)

153.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the property valuation requirements described in chapter 153. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to market value and condition of the property.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on property valuation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

153.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the property valuation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to market value and condition of the property.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the property valuation activities in chapter 153.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

153.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for property valuation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 153.3: Stages and time limits - property valuation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

153.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the property valuation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving market value and condition of the property that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

153.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to property valuation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on property valuation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 153.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 153.5: Reporting calendar - property valuation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 154: Legal and title scrutiny (Part 11)

154.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the legal and title scrutiny requirements described in chapter 154. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and marketable title.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on legal and title scrutiny is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

154.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the legal and title scrutiny requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and marketable title.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the legal and title scrutiny activities in chapter 154.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

154.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for legal and title scrutiny is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 154.3: Stages and time limits - legal and title scrutiny

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

154.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the legal and title scrutiny requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and marketable title that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

154.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to legal and title scrutiny are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on legal and title scrutiny to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 154.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 154.5: Reporting calendar - legal and title scrutiny

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 155: KYC and anti-money-laundering checks (Part 11)

155.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements described in chapter 155. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to customer identity and source of funds.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

155.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to customer identity and source of funds.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks activities in chapter 155.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

155.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 155.3: Stages and time limits - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

155.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving customer identity and source of funds that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

155.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to kyc and anti-money-laundering checks are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 155.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 155.5: Reporting calendar - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 156: Loan documentation (Part 11)

156.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the loan documentation requirements described in chapter 156. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on loan documentation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

156.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the loan documentation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the loan documentation activities in chapter 156.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

156.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for loan documentation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 156.3: Stages and time limits - loan documentation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

156.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the loan documentation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving completeness and accuracy of signed documents that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

156.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to loan documentation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on loan documentation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 156.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 156.5: Reporting calendar - loan documentation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 157: Disbursement conditions (Part 11)

157.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the disbursement conditions requirements described in chapter 157. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on disbursement conditions is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

157.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the disbursement conditions requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the disbursement conditions activities in chapter 157.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

157.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for disbursement conditions is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 157.3: Stages and time limits - disbursement conditions

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

157.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the disbursement conditions requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving conditions to be met before funds are released that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

157.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to disbursement conditions are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on disbursement conditions to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 157.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 157.5: Reporting calendar - disbursement conditions

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 158: Collections and recovery (Part 11)

158.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the collections and recovery requirements described in chapter 158. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on collections and recovery is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

158.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the collections and recovery requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the collections and recovery activities in chapter 158.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

158.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for collections and recovery is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 158.3: Stages and time limits - collections and recovery

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

158.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the collections and recovery requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

158.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to collections and recovery are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on collections and recovery to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 158.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 158.5: Reporting calendar - collections and recovery

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 159: Customer grievance handling (Part 11)

159.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer grievance handling requirements described in chapter 159. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer grievance handling is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

159.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer grievance handling requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer grievance handling activities in chapter 159.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

159.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer grievance handling is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 159.3: Stages and time limits - customer grievance handling

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

159.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer grievance handling requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

159.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer grievance handling are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer grievance handling to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 159.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 159.5: Reporting calendar - customer grievance handling

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 160: Internal audit and compliance (Part 11)

160.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the internal audit and compliance requirements described in chapter 160. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on internal audit and compliance is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

160.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the internal audit and compliance requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the internal audit and compliance activities in chapter 160.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

160.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for internal audit and compliance is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 160.3: Stages and time limits - internal audit and compliance

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

160.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the internal audit and compliance requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

160.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to internal audit and compliance are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on internal audit and compliance to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 160.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 160.5: Reporting calendar - internal audit and compliance

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 161: Data privacy and record keeping (Part 11)

161.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the data privacy and record keeping requirements described in chapter 161. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to safe handling of personal information.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on data privacy and record keeping is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

161.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the data privacy and record keeping requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to safe handling of personal information.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the data privacy and record keeping activities in chapter 161.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

161.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for data privacy and record keeping is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 161.3: Stages and time limits - data privacy and record keeping

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

161.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the data privacy and record keeping requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving safe handling of personal information that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

161.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to data privacy and record keeping are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on data privacy and record keeping to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 161.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 161.5: Reporting calendar - data privacy and record keeping

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 162: Fraud monitoring (Part 11)

162.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the fraud monitoring requirements described in chapter 162. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on fraud monitoring is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

162.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the fraud monitoring requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the fraud monitoring activities in chapter 162.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

162.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for fraud monitoring is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 162.3: Stages and time limits - fraud monitoring

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

162.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the fraud monitoring requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving red-flag indicators and escalation that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

162.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to fraud monitoring are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on fraud monitoring to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 162.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 162.5: Reporting calendar - fraud monitoring

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 163: Customer communication (Part 11)

163.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer communication requirements described in chapter 163. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and timely communication to customers.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer communication is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

163.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer communication requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and timely communication to customers.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer communication activities in chapter 163.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

163.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer communication is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 163.3: Stages and time limits - customer communication

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

163.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer communication requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and timely communication to customers that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

163.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer communication are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer communication to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 163.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 163.5: Reporting calendar - customer communication

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 164: Staff training and certification (Part 11)

164.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the staff training and certification requirements described in chapter 164. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on staff training and certification is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

164.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the staff training and certification requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the staff training and certification activities in chapter 164.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

164.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for staff training and certification is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 164.3: Stages and time limits - staff training and certification

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

164.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the staff training and certification requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

164.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to staff training and certification are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on staff training and certification to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 164.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 164.5: Reporting calendar - staff training and certification

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 165: Credit appraisal (Part 12)

165.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the credit appraisal requirements described in chapter 165. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on credit appraisal is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

165.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the credit appraisal requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the credit appraisal activities in chapter 165.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

165.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for credit appraisal is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 165.3: Stages and time limits - credit appraisal

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

165.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the credit appraisal requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving repayment capacity and existing obligations that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

165.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to credit appraisal are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on credit appraisal to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 165.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 165.5: Reporting calendar - credit appraisal

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 166: Income assessment (Part 12)

166.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the income assessment requirements described in chapter 166. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to the stability and verifiability of income.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on income assessment is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

166.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the income assessment requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to the stability and verifiability of income.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the income assessment activities in chapter 166.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

166.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for income assessment is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 166.3: Stages and time limits - income assessment

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

166.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the income assessment requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving the stability and verifiability of income that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

166.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to income assessment are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on income assessment to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 166.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 166.5: Reporting calendar - income assessment

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 167: Property valuation (Part 12)

167.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the property valuation requirements described in chapter 167. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to market value and condition of the property.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on property valuation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

167.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the property valuation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to market value and condition of the property.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the property valuation activities in chapter 167.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

167.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for property valuation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 167.3: Stages and time limits - property valuation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

167.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the property valuation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving market value and condition of the property that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

167.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to property valuation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on property valuation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 167.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 167.5: Reporting calendar - property valuation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 168: Legal and title scrutiny (Part 12)

168.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the legal and title scrutiny requirements described in chapter 168. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and marketable title.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on legal and title scrutiny is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

168.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the legal and title scrutiny requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and marketable title.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the legal and title scrutiny activities in chapter 168.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

168.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for legal and title scrutiny is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 168.3: Stages and time limits - legal and title scrutiny

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

168.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the legal and title scrutiny requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and marketable title that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

168.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to legal and title scrutiny are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on legal and title scrutiny to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 168.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 168.5: Reporting calendar - legal and title scrutiny

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 169: KYC and anti-money-laundering checks (Part 12)

169.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements described in chapter 169. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to customer identity and source of funds.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

169.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to customer identity and source of funds.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks activities in chapter 169.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

169.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 169.3: Stages and time limits - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

169.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving customer identity and source of funds that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

169.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to kyc and anti-money-laundering checks are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 169.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 169.5: Reporting calendar - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 170: Loan documentation (Part 12)

170.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the loan documentation requirements described in chapter 170. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on loan documentation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

170.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the loan documentation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the loan documentation activities in chapter 170.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

170.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for loan documentation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 170.3: Stages and time limits - loan documentation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

170.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the loan documentation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving completeness and accuracy of signed documents that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

170.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to loan documentation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on loan documentation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 170.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 170.5: Reporting calendar - loan documentation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 171: Disbursement conditions (Part 12)

171.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the disbursement conditions requirements described in chapter 171. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on disbursement conditions is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

171.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the disbursement conditions requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the disbursement conditions activities in chapter 171.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

171.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for disbursement conditions is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 171.3: Stages and time limits - disbursement conditions

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

171.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the disbursement conditions requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving conditions to be met before funds are released that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

171.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to disbursement conditions are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on disbursement conditions to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 171.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 171.5: Reporting calendar - disbursement conditions

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 172: Collections and recovery (Part 12)

172.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the collections and recovery requirements described in chapter 172. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on collections and recovery is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

172.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the collections and recovery requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the collections and recovery activities in chapter 172.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

172.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for collections and recovery is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 172.3: Stages and time limits - collections and recovery

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

172.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the collections and recovery requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

172.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to collections and recovery are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on collections and recovery to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 172.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 172.5: Reporting calendar - collections and recovery

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 173: Customer grievance handling (Part 12)

173.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer grievance handling requirements described in chapter 173. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer grievance handling is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

173.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer grievance handling requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer grievance handling activities in chapter 173.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

173.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer grievance handling is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 173.3: Stages and time limits - customer grievance handling

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

173.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer grievance handling requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

173.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer grievance handling are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer grievance handling to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 173.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 173.5: Reporting calendar - customer grievance handling

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 174: Internal audit and compliance (Part 12)

174.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the internal audit and compliance requirements described in chapter 174. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on internal audit and compliance is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

174.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the internal audit and compliance requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the internal audit and compliance activities in chapter 174.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

174.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for internal audit and compliance is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 174.3: Stages and time limits - internal audit and compliance

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

174.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the internal audit and compliance requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

174.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to internal audit and compliance are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on internal audit and compliance to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 174.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 174.5: Reporting calendar - internal audit and compliance

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 175: Data privacy and record keeping (Part 12)

175.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the data privacy and record keeping requirements described in chapter 175. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to safe handling of personal information.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on data privacy and record keeping is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

175.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the data privacy and record keeping requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to safe handling of personal information.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the data privacy and record keeping activities in chapter 175.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

175.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for data privacy and record keeping is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 175.3: Stages and time limits - data privacy and record keeping

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

175.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the data privacy and record keeping requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving safe handling of personal information that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

175.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to data privacy and record keeping are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on data privacy and record keeping to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 175.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 175.5: Reporting calendar - data privacy and record keeping

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 176: Fraud monitoring (Part 12)

176.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the fraud monitoring requirements described in chapter 176. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on fraud monitoring is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

176.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the fraud monitoring requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the fraud monitoring activities in chapter 176.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

176.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for fraud monitoring is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 176.3: Stages and time limits - fraud monitoring

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

176.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the fraud monitoring requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving red-flag indicators and escalation that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

176.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to fraud monitoring are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on fraud monitoring to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 176.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 176.5: Reporting calendar - fraud monitoring

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 177: Customer communication (Part 12)

177.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer communication requirements described in chapter 177. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and timely communication to customers.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer communication is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

177.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer communication requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and timely communication to customers.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer communication activities in chapter 177.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

177.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer communication is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 177.3: Stages and time limits - customer communication

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

177.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer communication requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and timely communication to customers that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

177.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer communication are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer communication to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 177.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 177.5: Reporting calendar - customer communication

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 178: Staff training and certification (Part 12)

178.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the staff training and certification requirements described in chapter 178. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on staff training and certification is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

178.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the staff training and certification requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the staff training and certification activities in chapter 178.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

178.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for staff training and certification is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 178.3: Stages and time limits - staff training and certification

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

178.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the staff training and certification requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

178.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to staff training and certification are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on staff training and certification to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 178.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 178.5: Reporting calendar - staff training and certification

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 179: Credit appraisal (Part 13)

179.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the credit appraisal requirements described in chapter 179. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on credit appraisal is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

179.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the credit appraisal requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the credit appraisal activities in chapter 179.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

179.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for credit appraisal is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 179.3: Stages and time limits - credit appraisal

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

179.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the credit appraisal requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving repayment capacity and existing obligations that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

179.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to credit appraisal are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on credit appraisal to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 179.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 179.5: Reporting calendar - credit appraisal

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 180: Income assessment (Part 13)

180.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the income assessment requirements described in chapter 180. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to the stability and verifiability of income.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on income assessment is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

180.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the income assessment requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to the stability and verifiability of income.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the income assessment activities in chapter 180.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

180.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for income assessment is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 180.3: Stages and time limits - income assessment

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

180.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the income assessment requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving the stability and verifiability of income that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

180.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to income assessment are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on income assessment to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 180.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 180.5: Reporting calendar - income assessment

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 181: Property valuation (Part 13)

181.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the property valuation requirements described in chapter 181. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to market value and condition of the property.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on property valuation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

181.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the property valuation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to market value and condition of the property.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the property valuation activities in chapter 181.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

181.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for property valuation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 181.3: Stages and time limits - property valuation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

181.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the property valuation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving market value and condition of the property that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

181.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to property valuation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on property valuation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 181.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 181.5: Reporting calendar - property valuation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 182: Legal and title scrutiny (Part 13)

182.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the legal and title scrutiny requirements described in chapter 182. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and marketable title.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on legal and title scrutiny is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

182.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the legal and title scrutiny requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and marketable title.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the legal and title scrutiny activities in chapter 182.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

182.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for legal and title scrutiny is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 182.3: Stages and time limits - legal and title scrutiny

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

182.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the legal and title scrutiny requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and marketable title that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

182.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to legal and title scrutiny are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on legal and title scrutiny to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 182.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 182.5: Reporting calendar - legal and title scrutiny

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 183: KYC and anti-money-laundering checks (Part 13)

183.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements described in chapter 183. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to customer identity and source of funds.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

183.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to customer identity and source of funds.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks activities in chapter 183.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

183.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 183.3: Stages and time limits - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

183.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving customer identity and source of funds that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

183.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to kyc and anti-money-laundering checks are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 183.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 183.5: Reporting calendar - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 184: Loan documentation (Part 13)

184.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the loan documentation requirements described in chapter 184. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on loan documentation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

184.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the loan documentation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the loan documentation activities in chapter 184.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

184.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for loan documentation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 184.3: Stages and time limits - loan documentation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

184.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the loan documentation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving completeness and accuracy of signed documents that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

184.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to loan documentation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on loan documentation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 184.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 184.5: Reporting calendar - loan documentation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 185: Disbursement conditions (Part 13)

185.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the disbursement conditions requirements described in chapter 185. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on disbursement conditions is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

185.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the disbursement conditions requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the disbursement conditions activities in chapter 185.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

185.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for disbursement conditions is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 185.3: Stages and time limits - disbursement conditions

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

185.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the disbursement conditions requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving conditions to be met before funds are released that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

185.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to disbursement conditions are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on disbursement conditions to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 185.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 185.5: Reporting calendar - disbursement conditions

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 186: Collections and recovery (Part 13)

186.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the collections and recovery requirements described in chapter 186. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on collections and recovery is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

186.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the collections and recovery requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the collections and recovery activities in chapter 186.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

186.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for collections and recovery is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 186.3: Stages and time limits - collections and recovery

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

186.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the collections and recovery requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

186.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to collections and recovery are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on collections and recovery to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 186.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 186.5: Reporting calendar - collections and recovery

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 187: Customer grievance handling (Part 13)

187.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer grievance handling requirements described in chapter 187. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer grievance handling is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

187.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer grievance handling requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer grievance handling activities in chapter 187.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

187.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer grievance handling is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 187.3: Stages and time limits - customer grievance handling

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

187.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer grievance handling requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

187.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer grievance handling are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer grievance handling to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 187.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 187.5: Reporting calendar - customer grievance handling

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 188: Internal audit and compliance (Part 13)

188.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the internal audit and compliance requirements described in chapter 188. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on internal audit and compliance is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

188.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the internal audit and compliance requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the internal audit and compliance activities in chapter 188.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

188.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for internal audit and compliance is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 188.3: Stages and time limits - internal audit and compliance

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

188.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the internal audit and compliance requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

188.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to internal audit and compliance are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on internal audit and compliance to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 188.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 188.5: Reporting calendar - internal audit and compliance

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 189: Data privacy and record keeping (Part 13)

189.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the data privacy and record keeping requirements described in chapter 189. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to safe handling of personal information.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on data privacy and record keeping is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

189.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the data privacy and record keeping requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to safe handling of personal information.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the data privacy and record keeping activities in chapter 189.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

189.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for data privacy and record keeping is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 189.3: Stages and time limits - data privacy and record keeping

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

189.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the data privacy and record keeping requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving safe handling of personal information that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

189.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to data privacy and record keeping are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on data privacy and record keeping to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 189.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 189.5: Reporting calendar - data privacy and record keeping

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 190: Fraud monitoring (Part 13)

190.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the fraud monitoring requirements described in chapter 190. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on fraud monitoring is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

190.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the fraud monitoring requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the fraud monitoring activities in chapter 190.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

190.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for fraud monitoring is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 190.3: Stages and time limits - fraud monitoring

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

190.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the fraud monitoring requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving red-flag indicators and escalation that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

190.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to fraud monitoring are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on fraud monitoring to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 190.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 190.5: Reporting calendar - fraud monitoring

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 191: Customer communication (Part 13)

191.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer communication requirements described in chapter 191. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and timely communication to customers.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer communication is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

191.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer communication requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and timely communication to customers.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer communication activities in chapter 191.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

191.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer communication is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 191.3: Stages and time limits - customer communication

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

191.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer communication requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and timely communication to customers that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

191.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer communication are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer communication to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 191.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 191.5: Reporting calendar - customer communication

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 192: Staff training and certification (Part 13)

192.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the staff training and certification requirements described in chapter 192. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on staff training and certification is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

192.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the staff training and certification requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the staff training and certification activities in chapter 192.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

192.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for staff training and certification is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 192.3: Stages and time limits - staff training and certification

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

192.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the staff training and certification requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

192.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to staff training and certification are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on staff training and certification to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 192.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 192.5: Reporting calendar - staff training and certification

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 193: Credit appraisal (Part 14)

193.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the credit appraisal requirements described in chapter 193. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on credit appraisal is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

193.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the credit appraisal requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the credit appraisal activities in chapter 193.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

193.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for credit appraisal is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 193.3: Stages and time limits - credit appraisal

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

193.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the credit appraisal requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving repayment capacity and existing obligations that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

193.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to credit appraisal are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on credit appraisal to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 193.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 193.5: Reporting calendar - credit appraisal

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 194: Income assessment (Part 14)

194.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the income assessment requirements described in chapter 194. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to the stability and verifiability of income.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on income assessment is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

194.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the income assessment requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to the stability and verifiability of income.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the income assessment activities in chapter 194.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

194.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for income assessment is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 194.3: Stages and time limits - income assessment

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

194.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the income assessment requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving the stability and verifiability of income that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

194.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to income assessment are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on income assessment to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 194.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 194.5: Reporting calendar - income assessment

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 195: Property valuation (Part 14)

195.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the property valuation requirements described in chapter 195. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to market value and condition of the property.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on property valuation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

195.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the property valuation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to market value and condition of the property.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the property valuation activities in chapter 195.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

195.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for property valuation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 195.3: Stages and time limits - property valuation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

195.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the property valuation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving market value and condition of the property that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

195.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to property valuation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on property valuation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 195.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 195.5: Reporting calendar - property valuation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 196: Legal and title scrutiny (Part 14)

196.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the legal and title scrutiny requirements described in chapter 196. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and marketable title.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on legal and title scrutiny is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

196.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the legal and title scrutiny requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and marketable title.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the legal and title scrutiny activities in chapter 196.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

196.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for legal and title scrutiny is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 196.3: Stages and time limits - legal and title scrutiny

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

196.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the legal and title scrutiny requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and marketable title that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

196.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to legal and title scrutiny are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on legal and title scrutiny to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 196.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 196.5: Reporting calendar - legal and title scrutiny

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 197: KYC and anti-money-laundering checks (Part 14)

197.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements described in chapter 197. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to customer identity and source of funds.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

197.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to customer identity and source of funds.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks activities in chapter 197.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

197.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 197.3: Stages and time limits - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

197.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving customer identity and source of funds that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

197.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to kyc and anti-money-laundering checks are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 197.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 197.5: Reporting calendar - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 198: Loan documentation (Part 14)

198.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the loan documentation requirements described in chapter 198. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on loan documentation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

198.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the loan documentation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the loan documentation activities in chapter 198.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

198.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for loan documentation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 198.3: Stages and time limits - loan documentation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

198.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the loan documentation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving completeness and accuracy of signed documents that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

198.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to loan documentation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on loan documentation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 198.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 198.5: Reporting calendar - loan documentation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 199: Disbursement conditions (Part 14)

199.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the disbursement conditions requirements described in chapter 199. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on disbursement conditions is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

199.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the disbursement conditions requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the disbursement conditions activities in chapter 199.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

199.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for disbursement conditions is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 199.3: Stages and time limits - disbursement conditions

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

199.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the disbursement conditions requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving conditions to be met before funds are released that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

199.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to disbursement conditions are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on disbursement conditions to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 199.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 199.5: Reporting calendar - disbursement conditions

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 200: Collections and recovery (Part 14)

200.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the collections and recovery requirements described in chapter 200. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on collections and recovery is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

200.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the collections and recovery requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the collections and recovery activities in chapter 200.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

200.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for collections and recovery is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 200.3: Stages and time limits - collections and recovery

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

200.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the collections and recovery requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

200.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to collections and recovery are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on collections and recovery to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 200.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 200.5: Reporting calendar - collections and recovery

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 201: Customer grievance handling (Part 14)

201.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer grievance handling requirements described in chapter 201. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer grievance handling is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

201.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer grievance handling requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer grievance handling activities in chapter 201.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

201.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer grievance handling is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 201.3: Stages and time limits - customer grievance handling

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

201.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer grievance handling requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

201.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer grievance handling are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer grievance handling to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 201.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 201.5: Reporting calendar - customer grievance handling

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 202: Internal audit and compliance (Part 14)

202.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the internal audit and compliance requirements described in chapter 202. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on internal audit and compliance is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

202.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the internal audit and compliance requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the internal audit and compliance activities in chapter 202.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

202.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for internal audit and compliance is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 202.3: Stages and time limits - internal audit and compliance

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

202.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the internal audit and compliance requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

202.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to internal audit and compliance are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on internal audit and compliance to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 202.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 202.5: Reporting calendar - internal audit and compliance

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 203: Data privacy and record keeping (Part 14)

203.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the data privacy and record keeping requirements described in chapter 203. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to safe handling of personal information.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on data privacy and record keeping is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

203.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the data privacy and record keeping requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to safe handling of personal information.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the data privacy and record keeping activities in chapter 203.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

203.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for data privacy and record keeping is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 203.3: Stages and time limits - data privacy and record keeping

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

203.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the data privacy and record keeping requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving safe handling of personal information that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

203.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to data privacy and record keeping are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on data privacy and record keeping to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 203.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 203.5: Reporting calendar - data privacy and record keeping

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 204: Fraud monitoring (Part 14)

204.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the fraud monitoring requirements described in chapter 204. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on fraud monitoring is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

204.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the fraud monitoring requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the fraud monitoring activities in chapter 204.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

204.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for fraud monitoring is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 204.3: Stages and time limits - fraud monitoring

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

204.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the fraud monitoring requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving red-flag indicators and escalation that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

204.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to fraud monitoring are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on fraud monitoring to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 204.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 204.5: Reporting calendar - fraud monitoring

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 205: Customer communication (Part 14)

205.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer communication requirements described in chapter 205. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and timely communication to customers.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer communication is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

205.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer communication requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and timely communication to customers.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer communication activities in chapter 205.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

205.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer communication is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 205.3: Stages and time limits - customer communication

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

205.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer communication requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and timely communication to customers that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

205.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer communication are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer communication to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 205.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 205.5: Reporting calendar - customer communication

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 206: Staff training and certification (Part 14)

206.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the staff training and certification requirements described in chapter 206. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on staff training and certification is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

206.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the staff training and certification requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the staff training and certification activities in chapter 206.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

206.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for staff training and certification is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 206.3: Stages and time limits - staff training and certification

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

206.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the staff training and certification requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

206.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to staff training and certification are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on staff training and certification to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 206.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 206.5: Reporting calendar - staff training and certification

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 207: Credit appraisal (Part 15)

207.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the credit appraisal requirements described in chapter 207. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on credit appraisal is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

207.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the credit appraisal requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the credit appraisal activities in chapter 207.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

207.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for credit appraisal is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 207.3: Stages and time limits - credit appraisal

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

207.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the credit appraisal requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving repayment capacity and existing obligations that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

207.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to credit appraisal are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on credit appraisal to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 207.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 207.5: Reporting calendar - credit appraisal

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 208: Income assessment (Part 15)

208.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the income assessment requirements described in chapter 208. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to the stability and verifiability of income.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on income assessment is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

208.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the income assessment requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to the stability and verifiability of income.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the income assessment activities in chapter 208.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

208.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for income assessment is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 208.3: Stages and time limits - income assessment

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

208.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the income assessment requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving the stability and verifiability of income that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

208.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to income assessment are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on income assessment to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 208.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 208.5: Reporting calendar - income assessment

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 209: Property valuation (Part 15)

209.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the property valuation requirements described in chapter 209. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to market value and condition of the property.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on property valuation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

209.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the property valuation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to market value and condition of the property.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the property valuation activities in chapter 209.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

209.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for property valuation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 209.3: Stages and time limits - property valuation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

209.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the property valuation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving market value and condition of the property that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

209.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to property valuation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on property valuation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 209.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 209.5: Reporting calendar - property valuation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 210: Legal and title scrutiny (Part 15)

210.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the legal and title scrutiny requirements described in chapter 210. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and marketable title.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on legal and title scrutiny is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

210.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the legal and title scrutiny requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and marketable title.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the legal and title scrutiny activities in chapter 210.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

210.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for legal and title scrutiny is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 210.3: Stages and time limits - legal and title scrutiny

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

210.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the legal and title scrutiny requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and marketable title that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

210.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to legal and title scrutiny are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on legal and title scrutiny to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 210.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 210.5: Reporting calendar - legal and title scrutiny

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 211: KYC and anti-money-laundering checks (Part 15)

211.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements described in chapter 211. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to customer identity and source of funds.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

211.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to customer identity and source of funds.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks activities in chapter 211.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

211.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 211.3: Stages and time limits - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

211.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving customer identity and source of funds that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

211.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to kyc and anti-money-laundering checks are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 211.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 211.5: Reporting calendar - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 212: Loan documentation (Part 15)

212.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the loan documentation requirements described in chapter 212. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on loan documentation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

212.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the loan documentation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the loan documentation activities in chapter 212.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

212.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for loan documentation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 212.3: Stages and time limits - loan documentation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

212.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the loan documentation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving completeness and accuracy of signed documents that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

212.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to loan documentation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on loan documentation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 212.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 212.5: Reporting calendar - loan documentation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 213: Disbursement conditions (Part 15)

213.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the disbursement conditions requirements described in chapter 213. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on disbursement conditions is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

213.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the disbursement conditions requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the disbursement conditions activities in chapter 213.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

213.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for disbursement conditions is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 213.3: Stages and time limits - disbursement conditions

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

213.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the disbursement conditions requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving conditions to be met before funds are released that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

213.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to disbursement conditions are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on disbursement conditions to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 213.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 213.5: Reporting calendar - disbursement conditions

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 214: Collections and recovery (Part 15)

214.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the collections and recovery requirements described in chapter 214. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on collections and recovery is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

214.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the collections and recovery requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the collections and recovery activities in chapter 214.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

214.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for collections and recovery is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 214.3: Stages and time limits - collections and recovery

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

214.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the collections and recovery requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

214.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to collections and recovery are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on collections and recovery to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 214.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 214.5: Reporting calendar - collections and recovery

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 215: Customer grievance handling (Part 15)

215.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer grievance handling requirements described in chapter 215. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer grievance handling is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

215.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer grievance handling requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer grievance handling activities in chapter 215.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

215.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer grievance handling is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 215.3: Stages and time limits - customer grievance handling

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

215.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer grievance handling requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

215.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer grievance handling are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer grievance handling to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 215.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 215.5: Reporting calendar - customer grievance handling

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 216: Internal audit and compliance (Part 15)

216.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the internal audit and compliance requirements described in chapter 216. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on internal audit and compliance is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

216.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the internal audit and compliance requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the internal audit and compliance activities in chapter 216.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

216.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for internal audit and compliance is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 216.3: Stages and time limits - internal audit and compliance

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

216.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the internal audit and compliance requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

216.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to internal audit and compliance are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on internal audit and compliance to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 216.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 216.5: Reporting calendar - internal audit and compliance

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 217: Data privacy and record keeping (Part 15)

217.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the data privacy and record keeping requirements described in chapter 217. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to safe handling of personal information.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on data privacy and record keeping is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

217.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the data privacy and record keeping requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to safe handling of personal information.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the data privacy and record keeping activities in chapter 217.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

217.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for data privacy and record keeping is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 217.3: Stages and time limits - data privacy and record keeping

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

217.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the data privacy and record keeping requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving safe handling of personal information that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

217.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to data privacy and record keeping are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on data privacy and record keeping to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 217.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 217.5: Reporting calendar - data privacy and record keeping

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 218: Fraud monitoring (Part 15)

218.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the fraud monitoring requirements described in chapter 218. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on fraud monitoring is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

218.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the fraud monitoring requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the fraud monitoring activities in chapter 218.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

218.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for fraud monitoring is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 218.3: Stages and time limits - fraud monitoring

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

218.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the fraud monitoring requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving red-flag indicators and escalation that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

218.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to fraud monitoring are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on fraud monitoring to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 218.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 218.5: Reporting calendar - fraud monitoring

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 219: Customer communication (Part 15)

219.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer communication requirements described in chapter 219. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and timely communication to customers.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer communication is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

219.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer communication requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and timely communication to customers.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer communication activities in chapter 219.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

219.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer communication is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 219.3: Stages and time limits - customer communication

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

219.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer communication requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and timely communication to customers that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

219.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer communication are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer communication to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 219.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 219.5: Reporting calendar - customer communication

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 220: Staff training and certification (Part 15)

220.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the staff training and certification requirements described in chapter 220. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on staff training and certification is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

220.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the staff training and certification requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the staff training and certification activities in chapter 220.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

220.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for staff training and certification is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 220.3: Stages and time limits - staff training and certification

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

220.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the staff training and certification requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

220.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to staff training and certification are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on staff training and certification to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 220.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 220.5: Reporting calendar - staff training and certification

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 221: Credit appraisal (Part 16)

221.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the credit appraisal requirements described in chapter 221. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on credit appraisal is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

221.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the credit appraisal requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the credit appraisal activities in chapter 221.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

221.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for credit appraisal is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 221.3: Stages and time limits - credit appraisal

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

221.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the credit appraisal requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving repayment capacity and existing obligations that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

221.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to credit appraisal are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on credit appraisal to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 221.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 221.5: Reporting calendar - credit appraisal

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 222: Income assessment (Part 16)

222.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the income assessment requirements described in chapter 222. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to the stability and verifiability of income.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on income assessment is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

222.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the income assessment requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to the stability and verifiability of income.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the income assessment activities in chapter 222.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

222.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for income assessment is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 222.3: Stages and time limits - income assessment

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

222.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the income assessment requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving the stability and verifiability of income that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

222.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to income assessment are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on income assessment to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 222.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 222.5: Reporting calendar - income assessment

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 223: Property valuation (Part 16)

223.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the property valuation requirements described in chapter 223. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to market value and condition of the property.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on property valuation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

223.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the property valuation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to market value and condition of the property.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the property valuation activities in chapter 223.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

223.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for property valuation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 223.3: Stages and time limits - property valuation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

223.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the property valuation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving market value and condition of the property that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

223.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to property valuation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on property valuation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 223.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 223.5: Reporting calendar - property valuation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 224: Legal and title scrutiny (Part 16)

224.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the legal and title scrutiny requirements described in chapter 224. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and marketable title.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on legal and title scrutiny is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

224.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the legal and title scrutiny requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and marketable title.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the legal and title scrutiny activities in chapter 224.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

224.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for legal and title scrutiny is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 224.3: Stages and time limits - legal and title scrutiny

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

224.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the legal and title scrutiny requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and marketable title that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

224.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to legal and title scrutiny are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on legal and title scrutiny to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 224.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 224.5: Reporting calendar - legal and title scrutiny

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 225: KYC and anti-money-laundering checks (Part 16)

225.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements described in chapter 225. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to customer identity and source of funds.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

225.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to customer identity and source of funds.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks activities in chapter 225.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

225.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 225.3: Stages and time limits - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

225.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving customer identity and source of funds that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

225.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to kyc and anti-money-laundering checks are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 225.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 225.5: Reporting calendar - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 226: Loan documentation (Part 16)

226.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the loan documentation requirements described in chapter 226. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on loan documentation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

226.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the loan documentation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the loan documentation activities in chapter 226.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

226.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for loan documentation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 226.3: Stages and time limits - loan documentation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

226.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the loan documentation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving completeness and accuracy of signed documents that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

226.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to loan documentation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on loan documentation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 226.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 226.5: Reporting calendar - loan documentation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 227: Disbursement conditions (Part 16)

227.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the disbursement conditions requirements described in chapter 227. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on disbursement conditions is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

227.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the disbursement conditions requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the disbursement conditions activities in chapter 227.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

227.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for disbursement conditions is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 227.3: Stages and time limits - disbursement conditions

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

227.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the disbursement conditions requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving conditions to be met before funds are released that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

227.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to disbursement conditions are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on disbursement conditions to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 227.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 227.5: Reporting calendar - disbursement conditions

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 228: Collections and recovery (Part 16)

228.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the collections and recovery requirements described in chapter 228. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on collections and recovery is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

228.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the collections and recovery requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the collections and recovery activities in chapter 228.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

228.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for collections and recovery is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 228.3: Stages and time limits - collections and recovery

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

228.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the collections and recovery requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

228.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to collections and recovery are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on collections and recovery to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 228.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 228.5: Reporting calendar - collections and recovery

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 229: Customer grievance handling (Part 16)

229.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer grievance handling requirements described in chapter 229. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer grievance handling is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

229.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer grievance handling requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer grievance handling activities in chapter 229.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

229.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer grievance handling is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 229.3: Stages and time limits - customer grievance handling

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

229.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer grievance handling requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

229.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer grievance handling are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer grievance handling to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 229.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 229.5: Reporting calendar - customer grievance handling

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 230: Internal audit and compliance (Part 16)

230.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the internal audit and compliance requirements described in chapter 230. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on internal audit and compliance is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

230.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the internal audit and compliance requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the internal audit and compliance activities in chapter 230.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

230.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for internal audit and compliance is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 230.3: Stages and time limits - internal audit and compliance

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

230.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the internal audit and compliance requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

230.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to internal audit and compliance are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on internal audit and compliance to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 230.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 230.5: Reporting calendar - internal audit and compliance

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 231: Data privacy and record keeping (Part 16)

231.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the data privacy and record keeping requirements described in chapter 231. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to safe handling of personal information.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on data privacy and record keeping is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

231.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the data privacy and record keeping requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to safe handling of personal information.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the data privacy and record keeping activities in chapter 231.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

231.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for data privacy and record keeping is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 231.3: Stages and time limits - data privacy and record keeping

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

231.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the data privacy and record keeping requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving safe handling of personal information that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

231.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to data privacy and record keeping are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on data privacy and record keeping to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 231.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 231.5: Reporting calendar - data privacy and record keeping

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 232: Fraud monitoring (Part 16)

232.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the fraud monitoring requirements described in chapter 232. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on fraud monitoring is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

232.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the fraud monitoring requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the fraud monitoring activities in chapter 232.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

232.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for fraud monitoring is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 232.3: Stages and time limits - fraud monitoring

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

232.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the fraud monitoring requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving red-flag indicators and escalation that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

232.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to fraud monitoring are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on fraud monitoring to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 232.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 232.5: Reporting calendar - fraud monitoring

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 233: Customer communication (Part 16)

233.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer communication requirements described in chapter 233. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and timely communication to customers.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer communication is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

233.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer communication requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and timely communication to customers.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer communication activities in chapter 233.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

233.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer communication is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 233.3: Stages and time limits - customer communication

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

233.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer communication requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and timely communication to customers that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

233.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer communication are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer communication to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 233.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 233.5: Reporting calendar - customer communication

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 234: Staff training and certification (Part 16)

234.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the staff training and certification requirements described in chapter 234. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on staff training and certification is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

234.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the staff training and certification requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the staff training and certification activities in chapter 234.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

234.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for staff training and certification is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 234.3: Stages and time limits - staff training and certification

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

234.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the staff training and certification requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

234.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to staff training and certification are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on staff training and certification to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 234.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 234.5: Reporting calendar - staff training and certification

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 235: Credit appraisal (Part 17)

235.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the credit appraisal requirements described in chapter 235. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on credit appraisal is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

235.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the credit appraisal requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the credit appraisal activities in chapter 235.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

235.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for credit appraisal is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 235.3: Stages and time limits - credit appraisal

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

235.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the credit appraisal requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving repayment capacity and existing obligations that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

235.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to credit appraisal are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on credit appraisal to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 235.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 235.5: Reporting calendar - credit appraisal

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 236: Income assessment (Part 17)

236.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the income assessment requirements described in chapter 236. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to the stability and verifiability of income.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on income assessment is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

236.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the income assessment requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to the stability and verifiability of income.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the income assessment activities in chapter 236.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

236.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for income assessment is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 236.3: Stages and time limits - income assessment

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

236.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the income assessment requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving the stability and verifiability of income that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

236.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to income assessment are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on income assessment to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 236.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 236.5: Reporting calendar - income assessment

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 237: Property valuation (Part 17)

237.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the property valuation requirements described in chapter 237. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to market value and condition of the property.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on property valuation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

237.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the property valuation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to market value and condition of the property.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the property valuation activities in chapter 237.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

237.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for property valuation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 237.3: Stages and time limits - property valuation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

237.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the property valuation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving market value and condition of the property that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

237.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to property valuation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on property valuation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 237.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 237.5: Reporting calendar - property valuation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 238: Legal and title scrutiny (Part 17)

238.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the legal and title scrutiny requirements described in chapter 238. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and marketable title.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on legal and title scrutiny is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

238.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the legal and title scrutiny requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and marketable title.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the legal and title scrutiny activities in chapter 238.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

238.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for legal and title scrutiny is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 238.3: Stages and time limits - legal and title scrutiny

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

238.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the legal and title scrutiny requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and marketable title that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

238.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to legal and title scrutiny are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on legal and title scrutiny to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 238.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 238.5: Reporting calendar - legal and title scrutiny

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 239: KYC and anti-money-laundering checks (Part 17)

239.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements described in chapter 239. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to customer identity and source of funds.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

239.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to customer identity and source of funds.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks activities in chapter 239.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

239.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 239.3: Stages and time limits - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

239.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving customer identity and source of funds that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

239.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to kyc and anti-money-laundering checks are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 239.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 239.5: Reporting calendar - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 240: Loan documentation (Part 17)

240.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the loan documentation requirements described in chapter 240. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on loan documentation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

240.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the loan documentation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the loan documentation activities in chapter 240.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

240.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for loan documentation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 240.3: Stages and time limits - loan documentation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

240.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the loan documentation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving completeness and accuracy of signed documents that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

240.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to loan documentation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on loan documentation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 240.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 240.5: Reporting calendar - loan documentation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 241: Disbursement conditions (Part 17)

241.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the disbursement conditions requirements described in chapter 241. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on disbursement conditions is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

241.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the disbursement conditions requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the disbursement conditions activities in chapter 241.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

241.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for disbursement conditions is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 241.3: Stages and time limits - disbursement conditions

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

241.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the disbursement conditions requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving conditions to be met before funds are released that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

241.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to disbursement conditions are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on disbursement conditions to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 241.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 241.5: Reporting calendar - disbursement conditions

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 242: Collections and recovery (Part 17)

242.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the collections and recovery requirements described in chapter 242. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on collections and recovery is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

242.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the collections and recovery requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the collections and recovery activities in chapter 242.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

242.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for collections and recovery is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 242.3: Stages and time limits - collections and recovery

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

242.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the collections and recovery requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

242.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to collections and recovery are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on collections and recovery to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 242.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 242.5: Reporting calendar - collections and recovery

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 243: Customer grievance handling (Part 17)

243.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer grievance handling requirements described in chapter 243. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer grievance handling is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

243.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer grievance handling requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer grievance handling activities in chapter 243.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

243.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer grievance handling is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 243.3: Stages and time limits - customer grievance handling

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

243.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer grievance handling requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

243.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer grievance handling are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer grievance handling to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 243.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 243.5: Reporting calendar - customer grievance handling

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 244: Internal audit and compliance (Part 17)

244.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the internal audit and compliance requirements described in chapter 244. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on internal audit and compliance is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

244.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the internal audit and compliance requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the internal audit and compliance activities in chapter 244.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

244.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for internal audit and compliance is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 244.3: Stages and time limits - internal audit and compliance

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

244.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the internal audit and compliance requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

244.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to internal audit and compliance are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on internal audit and compliance to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 244.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 244.5: Reporting calendar - internal audit and compliance

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 245: Data privacy and record keeping (Part 17)

245.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the data privacy and record keeping requirements described in chapter 245. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to safe handling of personal information.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on data privacy and record keeping is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

245.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the data privacy and record keeping requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to safe handling of personal information.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the data privacy and record keeping activities in chapter 245.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

245.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for data privacy and record keeping is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 245.3: Stages and time limits - data privacy and record keeping

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

245.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the data privacy and record keeping requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving safe handling of personal information that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

245.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to data privacy and record keeping are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on data privacy and record keeping to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 245.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 245.5: Reporting calendar - data privacy and record keeping

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 246: Fraud monitoring (Part 17)

246.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the fraud monitoring requirements described in chapter 246. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on fraud monitoring is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

246.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the fraud monitoring requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the fraud monitoring activities in chapter 246.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

246.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for fraud monitoring is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 246.3: Stages and time limits - fraud monitoring

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

246.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the fraud monitoring requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving red-flag indicators and escalation that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

246.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to fraud monitoring are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on fraud monitoring to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 246.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 246.5: Reporting calendar - fraud monitoring

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 247: Customer communication (Part 17)

247.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer communication requirements described in chapter 247. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and timely communication to customers.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer communication is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

247.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer communication requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and timely communication to customers.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer communication activities in chapter 247.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

247.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer communication is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 247.3: Stages and time limits - customer communication

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

247.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer communication requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and timely communication to customers that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

247.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer communication are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer communication to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 247.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 247.5: Reporting calendar - customer communication

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 248: Staff training and certification (Part 17)

248.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the staff training and certification requirements described in chapter 248. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on staff training and certification is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

248.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the staff training and certification requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the staff training and certification activities in chapter 248.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

248.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for staff training and certification is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 248.3: Stages and time limits - staff training and certification

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

248.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the staff training and certification requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

248.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to staff training and certification are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on staff training and certification to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 248.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 248.5: Reporting calendar - staff training and certification

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 249: Credit appraisal (Part 18)

249.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the credit appraisal requirements described in chapter 249. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on credit appraisal is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

249.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the credit appraisal requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the credit appraisal activities in chapter 249.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

249.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for credit appraisal is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 249.3: Stages and time limits - credit appraisal

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

249.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the credit appraisal requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving repayment capacity and existing obligations that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

249.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to credit appraisal are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on credit appraisal to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 249.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 249.5: Reporting calendar - credit appraisal

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 250: Income assessment (Part 18)

250.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the income assessment requirements described in chapter 250. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to the stability and verifiability of income.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on income assessment is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

250.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the income assessment requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to the stability and verifiability of income.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the income assessment activities in chapter 250.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

250.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for income assessment is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 250.3: Stages and time limits - income assessment

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

250.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the income assessment requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving the stability and verifiability of income that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

250.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to income assessment are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on income assessment to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 250.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 250.5: Reporting calendar - income assessment

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 251: Property valuation (Part 18)

251.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the property valuation requirements described in chapter 251. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to market value and condition of the property.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on property valuation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

251.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the property valuation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to market value and condition of the property.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the property valuation activities in chapter 251.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

251.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for property valuation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 251.3: Stages and time limits - property valuation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

251.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the property valuation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving market value and condition of the property that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

251.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to property valuation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on property valuation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 251.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 251.5: Reporting calendar - property valuation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 252: Legal and title scrutiny (Part 18)

252.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the legal and title scrutiny requirements described in chapter 252. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and marketable title.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on legal and title scrutiny is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

252.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the legal and title scrutiny requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and marketable title.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the legal and title scrutiny activities in chapter 252.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

252.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for legal and title scrutiny is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 252.3: Stages and time limits - legal and title scrutiny

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

252.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the legal and title scrutiny requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and marketable title that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

252.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to legal and title scrutiny are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on legal and title scrutiny to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 252.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 252.5: Reporting calendar - legal and title scrutiny

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 253: KYC and anti-money-laundering checks (Part 18)

253.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements described in chapter 253. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to customer identity and source of funds.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

253.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to customer identity and source of funds.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks activities in chapter 253.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

253.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 253.3: Stages and time limits - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

253.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving customer identity and source of funds that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

253.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to kyc and anti-money-laundering checks are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 253.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 253.5: Reporting calendar - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 254: Loan documentation (Part 18)

254.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the loan documentation requirements described in chapter 254. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on loan documentation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

254.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the loan documentation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the loan documentation activities in chapter 254.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

254.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for loan documentation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 254.3: Stages and time limits - loan documentation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

254.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the loan documentation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving completeness and accuracy of signed documents that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

254.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to loan documentation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on loan documentation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 254.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 254.5: Reporting calendar - loan documentation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 255: Disbursement conditions (Part 18)

255.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the disbursement conditions requirements described in chapter 255. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on disbursement conditions is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

255.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the disbursement conditions requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the disbursement conditions activities in chapter 255.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

255.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for disbursement conditions is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 255.3: Stages and time limits - disbursement conditions

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

255.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the disbursement conditions requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving conditions to be met before funds are released that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

255.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to disbursement conditions are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on disbursement conditions to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 255.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 255.5: Reporting calendar - disbursement conditions

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 256: Collections and recovery (Part 18)

256.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the collections and recovery requirements described in chapter 256. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on collections and recovery is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

256.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the collections and recovery requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the collections and recovery activities in chapter 256.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

256.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for collections and recovery is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 256.3: Stages and time limits - collections and recovery

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

256.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the collections and recovery requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

256.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to collections and recovery are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on collections and recovery to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 256.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 256.5: Reporting calendar - collections and recovery

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 257: Customer grievance handling (Part 18)

257.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer grievance handling requirements described in chapter 257. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer grievance handling is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

257.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer grievance handling requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer grievance handling activities in chapter 257.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

257.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer grievance handling is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 257.3: Stages and time limits - customer grievance handling

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

257.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer grievance handling requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

257.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer grievance handling are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer grievance handling to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 257.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 257.5: Reporting calendar - customer grievance handling

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 258: Internal audit and compliance (Part 18)

258.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the internal audit and compliance requirements described in chapter 258. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on internal audit and compliance is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

258.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the internal audit and compliance requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the internal audit and compliance activities in chapter 258.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

258.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for internal audit and compliance is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 258.3: Stages and time limits - internal audit and compliance

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

258.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the internal audit and compliance requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

258.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to internal audit and compliance are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on internal audit and compliance to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 258.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 258.5: Reporting calendar - internal audit and compliance

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 259: Data privacy and record keeping (Part 18)

259.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the data privacy and record keeping requirements described in chapter 259. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to safe handling of personal information.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on data privacy and record keeping is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

259.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the data privacy and record keeping requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to safe handling of personal information.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the data privacy and record keeping activities in chapter 259.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

259.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for data privacy and record keeping is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 259.3: Stages and time limits - data privacy and record keeping

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

259.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the data privacy and record keeping requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving safe handling of personal information that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

259.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to data privacy and record keeping are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on data privacy and record keeping to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 259.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 259.5: Reporting calendar - data privacy and record keeping

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 260: Fraud monitoring (Part 18)

260.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the fraud monitoring requirements described in chapter 260. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on fraud monitoring is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

260.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the fraud monitoring requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the fraud monitoring activities in chapter 260.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

260.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for fraud monitoring is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 260.3: Stages and time limits - fraud monitoring

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

260.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the fraud monitoring requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving red-flag indicators and escalation that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

260.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to fraud monitoring are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on fraud monitoring to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 260.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 260.5: Reporting calendar - fraud monitoring

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 261: Customer communication (Part 18)

261.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer communication requirements described in chapter 261. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and timely communication to customers.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer communication is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

261.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer communication requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and timely communication to customers.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer communication activities in chapter 261.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

261.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer communication is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 261.3: Stages and time limits - customer communication

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

261.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer communication requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and timely communication to customers that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

261.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer communication are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer communication to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 261.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 261.5: Reporting calendar - customer communication

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 262: Staff training and certification (Part 18)

262.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the staff training and certification requirements described in chapter 262. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on staff training and certification is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

262.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the staff training and certification requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the staff training and certification activities in chapter 262.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

262.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for staff training and certification is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 262.3: Stages and time limits - staff training and certification

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

262.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the staff training and certification requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

262.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to staff training and certification are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on staff training and certification to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 262.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 262.5: Reporting calendar - staff training and certification

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 263: Credit appraisal (Part 19)

263.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the credit appraisal requirements described in chapter 263. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on credit appraisal is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

263.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the credit appraisal requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the credit appraisal activities in chapter 263.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

263.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for credit appraisal is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 263.3: Stages and time limits - credit appraisal

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

263.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the credit appraisal requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving repayment capacity and existing obligations that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

263.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to credit appraisal are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on credit appraisal to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 263.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 263.5: Reporting calendar - credit appraisal

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 264: Income assessment (Part 19)

264.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the income assessment requirements described in chapter 264. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to the stability and verifiability of income.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on income assessment is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

264.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the income assessment requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to the stability and verifiability of income.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the income assessment activities in chapter 264.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

264.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for income assessment is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 264.3: Stages and time limits - income assessment

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

264.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the income assessment requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving the stability and verifiability of income that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

264.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to income assessment are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on income assessment to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 264.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 264.5: Reporting calendar - income assessment

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 265: Property valuation (Part 19)

265.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the property valuation requirements described in chapter 265. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to market value and condition of the property.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on property valuation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

265.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the property valuation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to market value and condition of the property.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the property valuation activities in chapter 265.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

265.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for property valuation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 265.3: Stages and time limits - property valuation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

265.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the property valuation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving market value and condition of the property that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

265.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to property valuation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on property valuation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 265.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 265.5: Reporting calendar - property valuation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 266: Legal and title scrutiny (Part 19)

266.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the legal and title scrutiny requirements described in chapter 266. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and marketable title.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on legal and title scrutiny is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

266.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the legal and title scrutiny requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and marketable title.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the legal and title scrutiny activities in chapter 266.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

266.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for legal and title scrutiny is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 266.3: Stages and time limits - legal and title scrutiny

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

266.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the legal and title scrutiny requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and marketable title that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

266.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to legal and title scrutiny are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on legal and title scrutiny to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 266.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 266.5: Reporting calendar - legal and title scrutiny

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 267: KYC and anti-money-laundering checks (Part 19)

267.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements described in chapter 267. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to customer identity and source of funds.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

267.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to customer identity and source of funds.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks activities in chapter 267.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

267.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 267.3: Stages and time limits - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

267.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving customer identity and source of funds that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

267.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to kyc and anti-money-laundering checks are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 267.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 267.5: Reporting calendar - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 268: Loan documentation (Part 19)

268.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the loan documentation requirements described in chapter 268. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on loan documentation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

268.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the loan documentation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the loan documentation activities in chapter 268.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

268.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for loan documentation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 268.3: Stages and time limits - loan documentation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

268.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the loan documentation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving completeness and accuracy of signed documents that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

268.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to loan documentation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on loan documentation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 268.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 268.5: Reporting calendar - loan documentation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 269: Disbursement conditions (Part 19)

269.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the disbursement conditions requirements described in chapter 269. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on disbursement conditions is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

269.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the disbursement conditions requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the disbursement conditions activities in chapter 269.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

269.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for disbursement conditions is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 269.3: Stages and time limits - disbursement conditions

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

269.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the disbursement conditions requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving conditions to be met before funds are released that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

269.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to disbursement conditions are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on disbursement conditions to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 269.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 269.5: Reporting calendar - disbursement conditions

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 270: Collections and recovery (Part 19)

270.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the collections and recovery requirements described in chapter 270. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on collections and recovery is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

270.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the collections and recovery requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the collections and recovery activities in chapter 270.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

270.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for collections and recovery is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 270.3: Stages and time limits - collections and recovery

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

270.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the collections and recovery requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

270.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to collections and recovery are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on collections and recovery to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 270.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 270.5: Reporting calendar - collections and recovery

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 271: Customer grievance handling (Part 19)

271.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer grievance handling requirements described in chapter 271. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer grievance handling is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

271.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer grievance handling requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer grievance handling activities in chapter 271.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

271.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer grievance handling is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 271.3: Stages and time limits - customer grievance handling

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

271.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer grievance handling requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

271.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer grievance handling are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer grievance handling to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 271.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 271.5: Reporting calendar - customer grievance handling

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 272: Internal audit and compliance (Part 19)

272.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the internal audit and compliance requirements described in chapter 272. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on internal audit and compliance is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

272.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the internal audit and compliance requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the internal audit and compliance activities in chapter 272.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

272.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for internal audit and compliance is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 272.3: Stages and time limits - internal audit and compliance

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

272.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the internal audit and compliance requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

272.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to internal audit and compliance are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on internal audit and compliance to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 272.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 272.5: Reporting calendar - internal audit and compliance

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 273: Data privacy and record keeping (Part 19)

273.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the data privacy and record keeping requirements described in chapter 273. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to safe handling of personal information.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on data privacy and record keeping is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

273.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the data privacy and record keeping requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to safe handling of personal information.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the data privacy and record keeping activities in chapter 273.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

273.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for data privacy and record keeping is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 273.3: Stages and time limits - data privacy and record keeping

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

273.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the data privacy and record keeping requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving safe handling of personal information that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

273.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to data privacy and record keeping are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on data privacy and record keeping to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 273.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 273.5: Reporting calendar - data privacy and record keeping

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 274: Fraud monitoring (Part 19)

274.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the fraud monitoring requirements described in chapter 274. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on fraud monitoring is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

274.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the fraud monitoring requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the fraud monitoring activities in chapter 274.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

274.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for fraud monitoring is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 274.3: Stages and time limits - fraud monitoring

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

274.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the fraud monitoring requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving red-flag indicators and escalation that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

274.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to fraud monitoring are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on fraud monitoring to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 274.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 274.5: Reporting calendar - fraud monitoring

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 275: Customer communication (Part 19)

275.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer communication requirements described in chapter 275. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and timely communication to customers.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer communication is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

275.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer communication requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and timely communication to customers.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer communication activities in chapter 275.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

275.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer communication is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 275.3: Stages and time limits - customer communication

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

275.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer communication requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and timely communication to customers that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

275.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer communication are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer communication to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 275.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 275.5: Reporting calendar - customer communication

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 276: Staff training and certification (Part 19)

276.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the staff training and certification requirements described in chapter 276. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on staff training and certification is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

276.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the staff training and certification requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the staff training and certification activities in chapter 276.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

276.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for staff training and certification is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 276.3: Stages and time limits - staff training and certification

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

276.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the staff training and certification requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

276.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to staff training and certification are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on staff training and certification to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 276.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 276.5: Reporting calendar - staff training and certification

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 277: Credit appraisal (Part 20)

277.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the credit appraisal requirements described in chapter 277. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on credit appraisal is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

277.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the credit appraisal requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the credit appraisal activities in chapter 277.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

277.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for credit appraisal is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 277.3: Stages and time limits - credit appraisal

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

277.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the credit appraisal requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving repayment capacity and existing obligations that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

277.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to credit appraisal are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on credit appraisal to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 277.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 277.5: Reporting calendar - credit appraisal

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 278: Income assessment (Part 20)

278.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the income assessment requirements described in chapter 278. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to the stability and verifiability of income.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on income assessment is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

278.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the income assessment requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to the stability and verifiability of income.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the income assessment activities in chapter 278.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

278.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for income assessment is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 278.3: Stages and time limits - income assessment

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

278.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the income assessment requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving the stability and verifiability of income that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

278.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to income assessment are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on income assessment to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 278.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 278.5: Reporting calendar - income assessment

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 279: Property valuation (Part 20)

279.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the property valuation requirements described in chapter 279. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to market value and condition of the property.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on property valuation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

279.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the property valuation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to market value and condition of the property.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the property valuation activities in chapter 279.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

279.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for property valuation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 279.3: Stages and time limits - property valuation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

279.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the property valuation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving market value and condition of the property that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

279.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to property valuation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on property valuation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 279.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 279.5: Reporting calendar - property valuation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 280: Legal and title scrutiny (Part 20)

280.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the legal and title scrutiny requirements described in chapter 280. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and marketable title.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on legal and title scrutiny is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

280.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the legal and title scrutiny requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and marketable title.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the legal and title scrutiny activities in chapter 280.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

280.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for legal and title scrutiny is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 280.3: Stages and time limits - legal and title scrutiny

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

280.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the legal and title scrutiny requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and marketable title that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

280.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to legal and title scrutiny are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on legal and title scrutiny to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 280.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 280.5: Reporting calendar - legal and title scrutiny

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 281: KYC and anti-money-laundering checks (Part 20)

281.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements described in chapter 281. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to customer identity and source of funds.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

281.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to customer identity and source of funds.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks activities in chapter 281.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

281.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 281.3: Stages and time limits - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

281.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving customer identity and source of funds that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

281.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to kyc and anti-money-laundering checks are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 281.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 281.5: Reporting calendar - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 282: Loan documentation (Part 20)

282.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the loan documentation requirements described in chapter 282. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on loan documentation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

282.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the loan documentation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the loan documentation activities in chapter 282.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

282.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for loan documentation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 282.3: Stages and time limits - loan documentation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

282.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the loan documentation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving completeness and accuracy of signed documents that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

282.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to loan documentation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on loan documentation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 282.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 282.5: Reporting calendar - loan documentation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 283: Disbursement conditions (Part 20)

283.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the disbursement conditions requirements described in chapter 283. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on disbursement conditions is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

283.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the disbursement conditions requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the disbursement conditions activities in chapter 283.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

283.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for disbursement conditions is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 283.3: Stages and time limits - disbursement conditions

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

283.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the disbursement conditions requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving conditions to be met before funds are released that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

283.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to disbursement conditions are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on disbursement conditions to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 283.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 283.5: Reporting calendar - disbursement conditions

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 284: Collections and recovery (Part 20)

284.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the collections and recovery requirements described in chapter 284. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on collections and recovery is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

284.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the collections and recovery requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the collections and recovery activities in chapter 284.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

284.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for collections and recovery is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 284.3: Stages and time limits - collections and recovery

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

284.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the collections and recovery requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

284.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to collections and recovery are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on collections and recovery to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 284.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 284.5: Reporting calendar - collections and recovery

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 285: Customer grievance handling (Part 20)

285.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer grievance handling requirements described in chapter 285. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer grievance handling is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

285.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer grievance handling requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer grievance handling activities in chapter 285.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

285.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer grievance handling is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 285.3: Stages and time limits - customer grievance handling

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

285.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer grievance handling requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving acknowledgement, investigation and closure of complaints that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

285.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer grievance handling are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer grievance handling to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 285.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 285.5: Reporting calendar - customer grievance handling

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 286: Internal audit and compliance (Part 20)

286.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the internal audit and compliance requirements described in chapter 286. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on internal audit and compliance is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

286.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the internal audit and compliance requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the internal audit and compliance activities in chapter 286.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

286.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for internal audit and compliance is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 286.3: Stages and time limits - internal audit and compliance

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

286.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the internal audit and compliance requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving adherence to approved procedures and timely reporting that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

286.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to internal audit and compliance are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on internal audit and compliance to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 286.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 286.5: Reporting calendar - internal audit and compliance

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 287: Data privacy and record keeping (Part 20)

287.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the data privacy and record keeping requirements described in chapter 287. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to safe handling of personal information.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on data privacy and record keeping is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

287.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the data privacy and record keeping requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to safe handling of personal information.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the data privacy and record keeping activities in chapter 287.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

287.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for data privacy and record keeping is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 287.3: Stages and time limits - data privacy and record keeping

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

287.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the data privacy and record keeping requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving safe handling of personal information that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

287.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to data privacy and record keeping are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on data privacy and record keeping to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 287.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 287.5: Reporting calendar - data privacy and record keeping

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 288: Fraud monitoring (Part 20)

288.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the fraud monitoring requirements described in chapter 288. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on fraud monitoring is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

288.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the fraud monitoring requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to red-flag indicators and escalation.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the fraud monitoring activities in chapter 288.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

288.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for fraud monitoring is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 288.3: Stages and time limits - fraud monitoring

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

288.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the fraud monitoring requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving red-flag indicators and escalation that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

288.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to fraud monitoring are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on fraud monitoring to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 288.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 288.5: Reporting calendar - fraud monitoring

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 289: Customer communication (Part 20)

289.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the customer communication requirements described in chapter 289. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and timely communication to customers.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on customer communication is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

289.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the customer communication requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and timely communication to customers.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the customer communication activities in chapter 289.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

289.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for customer communication is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 289.3: Stages and time limits - customer communication

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

289.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the customer communication requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and timely communication to customers that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

289.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to customer communication are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on customer communication to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 289.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 289.5: Reporting calendar - customer communication

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 290: Staff training and certification (Part 20)

290.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the staff training and certification requirements described in chapter 290. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on staff training and certification is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

290.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the staff training and certification requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the staff training and certification activities in chapter 290.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

290.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for staff training and certification is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 290.3: Stages and time limits - staff training and certification

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

290.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the staff training and certification requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving role-based learning and periodic refresher assessment that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

290.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to staff training and certification are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on staff training and certification to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 290.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 290.5: Reporting calendar - staff training and certification

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 291: Credit appraisal (Part 21)

291.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the credit appraisal requirements described in chapter 291. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on credit appraisal is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

291.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the credit appraisal requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to repayment capacity and existing obligations.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the credit appraisal activities in chapter 291.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

291.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for credit appraisal is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 291.3: Stages and time limits - credit appraisal

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

291.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the credit appraisal requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving repayment capacity and existing obligations that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

291.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to credit appraisal are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on credit appraisal to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 291.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 291.5: Reporting calendar - credit appraisal

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 292: Income assessment (Part 21)

292.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the income assessment requirements described in chapter 292. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to the stability and verifiability of income.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on income assessment is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

292.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the income assessment requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to the stability and verifiability of income.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the income assessment activities in chapter 292.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

292.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for income assessment is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 292.3: Stages and time limits - income assessment

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	3 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	7 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	2 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

292.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the income assessment requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving the stability and verifiability of income that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

292.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to income assessment are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on income assessment to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 292.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 292.5: Reporting calendar - income assessment

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 293: Property valuation (Part 21)

293.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the property valuation requirements described in chapter 293. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to market value and condition of the property.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on property valuation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

293.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the property valuation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to market value and condition of the property.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the property valuation activities in chapter 293.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

293.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for property valuation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 293.3: Stages and time limits - property valuation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	6 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	1 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	3 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	5 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

293.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the property valuation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving market value and condition of the property that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

293.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to property valuation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on property valuation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 293.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 293.5: Reporting calendar - property valuation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 294: Legal and title scrutiny (Part 21)

294.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the legal and title scrutiny requirements described in chapter 294. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to clear and marketable title.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on legal and title scrutiny is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

294.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the legal and title scrutiny requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to clear and marketable title.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the legal and title scrutiny activities in chapter 294.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

294.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for legal and title scrutiny is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 294.3: Stages and time limits - legal and title scrutiny

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	2 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	6 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	1 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

294.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the legal and title scrutiny requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving clear and marketable title that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

294.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to legal and title scrutiny are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on legal and title scrutiny to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 294.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 294.5: Reporting calendar - legal and title scrutiny

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	6
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	9
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 295: KYC and anti-money-laundering checks (Part 21)

295.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements described in chapter 295. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to customer identity and source of funds.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

295.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to customer identity and source of funds.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks activities in chapter 295.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

295.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for kyc and anti-money-laundering checks is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 295.3: Stages and time limits - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	5 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	7 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	2 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	4 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

295.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the kyc and anti-money-laundering checks requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving customer identity and source of funds that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

295.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to kyc and anti-money-laundering checks are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on kyc and anti-money-laundering checks to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 295.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 295.5: Reporting calendar - kyc and anti-money-laundering checks

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	2
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	6
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 296: Loan documentation (Part 21)

296.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the loan documentation requirements described in chapter 296. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on loan documentation is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

296.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the loan documentation requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to completeness and accuracy of signed documents.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the loan documentation activities in chapter 296.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

296.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for loan documentation is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 296.3: Stages and time limits - loan documentation

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	1 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	3 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	5 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	7 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

296.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the loan documentation requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving completeness and accuracy of signed documents that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

296.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to loan documentation are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on loan documentation to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 296.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 296.5: Reporting calendar - loan documentation

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	3
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	8
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Chapter 297: Disbursement conditions (Part 21)

297.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the disbursement conditions requirements described in chapter 297. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on disbursement conditions is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

297.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the disbursement conditions requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to conditions to be met before funds are released.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the disbursement conditions activities in chapter 297.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.
- Retail Credit Policy Department: periodic review of this chapter.

297.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for disbursement conditions is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 297.3: Stages and time limits - disbursement conditions

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	4 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Review and verification	Credit Officer	6 working days
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	1 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	3 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

297.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the disbursement conditions requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving conditions to be met before funds are released that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

297.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to disbursement conditions are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on disbursement conditions to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 297.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 297.5: Reporting calendar - disbursement conditions

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	4
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	10
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	15

Chapter 298: Collections and recovery (Part 21)

298.1 Objective and applicability

This section sets out the objective and applicability of the collections and recovery requirements described in chapter 298. It applies to all branches, regional offices and the central processing centre that handle mortgage loan applications.

The Bank applies these requirements uniformly to every product covered by the Policy so that customers receive consistent treatment irrespective of the branch they approach. Particular attention is given to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Where a local instruction conflicts with this section, the requirement of this Policy applies unless the Head of Retail Credit has issued a written clarification.

Officers are expected to read this section together with the related sections of Part A and to ask the Retail Credit Policy Department for clarification when the intended application is unclear. Training material on collections and recovery is available on the staff portal.

- Applies to all new mortgage applications and to existing borrowers where a service request is raised.
- Covers home purchase, construction, improvement and loan against property products.
- Is read together with the other chapters of this Policy.

298.2 Roles and responsibilities

The Branch Manager is responsible for ensuring that the collections and recovery requirements are followed at the branch. The Credit Officer reviews each file and records observations on the file note, giving particular attention to early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice.

Regional Credit Managers monitor compliance on a sample basis and report material deviations to the Head of Retail Credit. Staff who are unsure of a requirement must seek guidance before proceeding.

Nothing in this section removes the personal accountability of each officer for the accuracy of the information recorded by that officer.

Role holders must not delegate a decision to a junior officer unless the delegation is recorded in writing. Where an officer is absent, the Branch Manager nominates a suitable replacement for the collections and recovery activities in chapter 298.

- Branch Manager: overall responsibility for compliance at branch level.
- Credit Officer: file review and recording of observations.
- Regional Credit Manager: sample monitoring and escalation.

298.3 Procedure and timelines

The procedure for collections and recovery is carried out in the stages shown in the table below. Each stage must be completed within the time limit shown, counted in working days from the date the file is received by the responsible officer.

Officers must record the date and time of each stage in the loan origination system. A file that cannot progress because of missing information is returned to the customer with a clear list of what is required.

Time limits stop running while the Bank is waiting for information from the customer and resume when the information is received.

Table 298.3: Stages and time limits - collections and recovery

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Receipt and logging	Branch Operations Officer	7 working days
Review and verification	Credit Officer	2 working days

Stage	Responsible officer	Time limit
Approval	Regional Credit Manager	4 working days
Communication to customer	Customer Service Executive	6 working days

The customer is informed of the outcome of each stage through the channel chosen at the time of application. Where a stage is delayed beyond its limit, the responsible officer records the reason and informs the customer of the revised date.

- Log every file on the day of receipt.
- Return incomplete files with a written list of missing items.
- Record the outcome of each stage in the system.

298.4 Exceptions and escalation

Any exception to the collections and recovery requirements must be requested in writing, with reasons, and approved by an officer at least one level above the officer who would normally decide the file.

Cases involving early contact with the borrower and fair recovery practice that cannot be resolved at branch level are escalated to the Regional Credit Manager and, where necessary, to the Regional Credit Committee.

Approved exceptions are reported in the monthly exceptions summary. Repeated exceptions of the same kind are reviewed to decide whether this Policy needs to be amended.

The escalation matrix is reviewed every year. Officers must not split a case into smaller parts to avoid escalation, and any attempt to do so is treated as a breach of the Bank's code of conduct.

- Written request stating the reason for the exception.
- Approval by an officer at least one level higher.
- Entry in the monthly exceptions summary.

298.5 Records and reporting

Records relating to collections and recovery are maintained in the loan file and in the loan origination system. Entries must be complete, dated and traceable to the officer who made them.

Branches submit a monthly report on collections and recovery to the regional office. The regional office consolidates these reports for the quarterly review by the Retail Credit Policy Department.

Records are retained for the period set out in the document retention register at the end of this document.

Internal audit tests a sample of loan files each year to confirm that the records described in section 298.5 are complete. Findings are shared with the Branch Manager and tracked until closed.

- Keep the loan file complete and in the prescribed order.
- Submit the monthly report by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Do not alter a closed record; add a dated correction note instead.

Table 298.5: Reporting calendar - collections and recovery

Report	Prepared by	Due (working days after month end)
Branch summary	Branch Manager	5
Regional consolidation	Regional Credit Manager	7
Policy department review	Retail Credit Policy Department	12

Annexure A - Branch Master

The table below lists the branches authorised to originate mortgage loans under this version of the Policy, with the grade of each branch. The grade decides the sanction limit in clause 9.1.

Branch ID	City	Region	Grade
BR-0001	Ahmedabad	West	Grade B
BR-0002	Mumbai	West	Grade C
BR-0003	Pune	West	Grade A
BR-0004	Delhi	North	Grade B
BR-0005	Jaipur	North	Grade C
BR-0006	Lucknow	North	Grade A
BR-0007	Kolkata	East	Grade B
BR-0008	Bhubaneswar	East	Grade C
BR-0009	Chennai	South	Grade A
BR-0010	Bengaluru	South	Grade B
BR-0011	Hyderabad	South	Grade C
BR-0012	Surat	West	Grade A
BR-0013	Ahmedabad	West	Grade B
BR-0014	Mumbai	West	Grade C
BR-0015	Pune	West	Grade A
BR-0016	Delhi	North	Grade B
BR-0017	Jaipur	North	Grade C
BR-0018	Lucknow	North	Grade A
BR-0019	Kolkata	East	Grade B
BR-0020	Bhubaneswar	East	Grade C
BR-0021	Chennai	South	Grade A
BR-0022	Bengaluru	South	Grade B
BR-0023	Hyderabad	South	Grade C
BR-0024	Surat	West	Grade A
BR-0025	Ahmedabad	West	Grade B
BR-0026	Mumbai	West	Grade C
BR-0027	Pune	West	Grade A
BR-0028	Delhi	North	Grade B
BR-0029	Jaipur	North	Grade C
BR-0030	Lucknow	North	Grade A
BR-0031	Kolkata	East	Grade B
BR-0032	Bhubaneswar	East	Grade C
BR-0033	Chennai	South	Grade A
BR-0034	Bengaluru	South	Grade B
BR-0035	Hyderabad	South	Grade C
BR-0036	Surat	West	Grade A
BR-0037	Ahmedabad	West	Grade B
BR-0038	Mumbai	West	Grade C
BR-0039	Pune	West	Grade A
BR-0040	Delhi	North	Grade B

Branch ID	City	Region	Grade
BR-0041	Jaipur	North	Grade C
BR-0042	Lucknow	North	Grade A
BR-0043	Kolkata	East	Grade B
BR-0044	Bhubaneswar	East	Grade C
BR-0045	Chennai	South	Grade A
BR-0046	Bengaluru	South	Grade B
BR-0047	Hyderabad	South	Grade C
BR-0048	Surat	West	Grade A
BR-0049	Ahmedabad	West	Grade B
BR-0050	Mumbai	West	Grade C
BR-0051	Pune	West	Grade A
BR-0052	Delhi	North	Grade B
BR-0053	Jaipur	North	Grade C
BR-0054	Lucknow	North	Grade A
BR-0055	Kolkata	East	Grade B
BR-0056	Bhubaneswar	East	Grade C
BR-0057	Chennai	South	Grade A
BR-0058	Bengaluru	South	Grade B
BR-0059	Hyderabad	South	Grade C
BR-0060	Surat	West	Grade A
BR-0061	Ahmedabad	West	Grade B
BR-0062	Mumbai	West	Grade C
BR-0063	Pune	West	Grade A
BR-0064	Delhi	North	Grade B
BR-0065	Jaipur	North	Grade C
BR-0066	Lucknow	North	Grade A
BR-0067	Kolkata	East	Grade B
BR-0068	Bhubaneswar	East	Grade C
BR-0069	Chennai	South	Grade A
BR-0070	Bengaluru	South	Grade B
BR-0071	Hyderabad	South	Grade C
BR-0072	Surat	West	Grade A
BR-0073	Ahmedabad	West	Grade B
BR-0074	Mumbai	West	Grade C
BR-0075	Pune	West	Grade A
BR-0076	Delhi	North	Grade B
BR-0077	Jaipur	North	Grade C
BR-0078	Lucknow	North	Grade A
BR-0079	Kolkata	East	Grade B
BR-0080	Bhubaneswar	East	Grade C
BR-0081	Chennai	South	Grade A
BR-0082	Bengaluru	South	Grade B
BR-0083	Hyderabad	South	Grade C
BR-0084	Surat	West	Grade A

Branch ID	City	Region	Grade
BR-0085	Ahmedabad	West	Grade B
BR-0086	Mumbai	West	Grade C
BR-0087	Pune	West	Grade A
BR-0088	Delhi	North	Grade B
BR-0089	Jaipur	North	Grade C
BR-0090	Lucknow	North	Grade A
BR-0091	Kolkata	East	Grade B
BR-0092	Bhubaneswar	East	Grade C
BR-0093	Chennai	South	Grade A
BR-0094	Bengaluru	South	Grade B
BR-0095	Hyderabad	South	Grade C
BR-0096	Surat	West	Grade A
BR-0097	Ahmedabad	West	Grade B
BR-0098	Mumbai	West	Grade C
BR-0099	Pune	West	Grade A
BR-0100	Delhi	North	Grade B
BR-0101	Jaipur	North	Grade C
BR-0102	Lucknow	North	Grade A
BR-0103	Kolkata	East	Grade B
BR-0104	Bhubaneswar	East	Grade C
BR-0105	Chennai	South	Grade A
BR-0106	Bengaluru	South	Grade B
BR-0107	Hyderabad	South	Grade C
BR-0108	Surat	West	Grade A
BR-0109	Ahmedabad	West	Grade B
BR-0110	Mumbai	West	Grade C
BR-0111	Pune	West	Grade A
BR-0112	Delhi	North	Grade B
BR-0113	Jaipur	North	Grade C
BR-0114	Lucknow	North	Grade A
BR-0115	Kolkata	East	Grade B
BR-0116	Bhubaneswar	East	Grade C
BR-0117	Chennai	South	Grade A
BR-0118	Bengaluru	South	Grade B
BR-0119	Hyderabad	South	Grade C
BR-0120	Surat	West	Grade A
BR-0121	Ahmedabad	West	Grade B
BR-0122	Mumbai	West	Grade C
BR-0123	Pune	West	Grade A
BR-0124	Delhi	North	Grade B
BR-0125	Jaipur	North	Grade C
BR-0126	Lucknow	North	Grade A
BR-0127	Kolkata	East	Grade B
BR-0128	Bhubaneswar	East	Grade C

Branch ID	City	Region	Grade
BR-0129	Chennai	South	Grade A
BR-0130	Bengaluru	South	Grade B
BR-0131	Hyderabad	South	Grade C
BR-0132	Surat	West	Grade A
BR-0133	Ahmedabad	West	Grade B
BR-0134	Mumbai	West	Grade C
BR-0135	Pune	West	Grade A
BR-0136	Delhi	North	Grade B
BR-0137	Jaipur	North	Grade C
BR-0138	Lucknow	North	Grade A
BR-0139	Kolkata	East	Grade B
BR-0140	Bhubaneswar	East	Grade C
BR-0141	Chennai	South	Grade A
BR-0142	Bengaluru	South	Grade B
BR-0143	Hyderabad	South	Grade C
BR-0144	Surat	West	Grade A
BR-0145	Ahmedabad	West	Grade B
BR-0146	Mumbai	West	Grade C
BR-0147	Pune	West	Grade A
BR-0148	Delhi	North	Grade B
BR-0149	Jaipur	North	Grade C
BR-0150	Lucknow	North	Grade A
BR-0151	Kolkata	East	Grade B
BR-0152	Bhubaneswar	East	Grade C
BR-0153	Chennai	South	Grade A
BR-0154	Bengaluru	South	Grade B
BR-0155	Hyderabad	South	Grade C
BR-0156	Surat	West	Grade A
BR-0157	Ahmedabad	West	Grade B
BR-0158	Mumbai	West	Grade C
BR-0159	Pune	West	Grade A
BR-0160	Delhi	North	Grade B
BR-0161	Jaipur	North	Grade C
BR-0162	Lucknow	North	Grade A
BR-0163	Kolkata	East	Grade B
BR-0164	Bhubaneswar	East	Grade C
BR-0165	Chennai	South	Grade A
BR-0166	Bengaluru	South	Grade B
BR-0167	Hyderabad	South	Grade C
BR-0168	Surat	West	Grade A
BR-0169	Ahmedabad	West	Grade B
BR-0170	Mumbai	West	Grade C
BR-0171	Pune	West	Grade A
BR-0172	Delhi	North	Grade B

Branch ID	City	Region	Grade
BR-0173	Jaipur	North	Grade C
BR-0174	Lucknow	North	Grade A
BR-0175	Kolkata	East	Grade B
BR-0176	Bhubaneswar	East	Grade C
BR-0177	Chennai	South	Grade A
BR-0178	Bengaluru	South	Grade B
BR-0179	Hyderabad	South	Grade C
BR-0180	Surat	West	Grade A
BR-0181	Ahmedabad	West	Grade B
BR-0182	Mumbai	West	Grade C
BR-0183	Pune	West	Grade A
BR-0184	Delhi	North	Grade B
BR-0185	Jaipur	North	Grade C
BR-0186	Lucknow	North	Grade A
BR-0187	Kolkata	East	Grade B
BR-0188	Bhubaneswar	East	Grade C
BR-0189	Chennai	South	Grade A
BR-0190	Bengaluru	South	Grade B
BR-0191	Hyderabad	South	Grade C
BR-0192	Surat	West	Grade A
BR-0193	Ahmedabad	West	Grade B
BR-0194	Mumbai	West	Grade C
BR-0195	Pune	West	Grade A
BR-0196	Delhi	North	Grade B
BR-0197	Jaipur	North	Grade C
BR-0198	Lucknow	North	Grade A
BR-0199	Kolkata	East	Grade B
BR-0200	Bhubaneswar	East	Grade C

Annexure B - Document Retention Register

The table below sets the period for which each class of document is retained after the loan is closed.

Class ID	Document class	Retention after loan closure
DC-00001	Title search report (series 1)	8 years
DC-00002	Sanction letter (series 2)	5 years
DC-00003	KYC pack (series 3)	10 years
DC-00004	Valuation report (series 4)	7 years
DC-00005	Legal opinion (series 5)	4 years
DC-00006	Insurance certificate (series 6)	9 years
DC-00007	Disbursement memo (series 7)	6 years
DC-00008	Sale deed copy (series 8)	3 years
DC-00009	Title search report (series 9)	8 years
DC-00010	Sanction letter (series 10)	5 years
DC-00011	KYC pack (series 11)	10 years
DC-00012	Valuation report (series 12)	7 years
DC-00013	Legal opinion (series 13)	4 years
DC-00014	Insurance certificate (series 14)	9 years
DC-00015	Disbursement memo (series 15)	6 years
DC-00016	Sale deed copy (series 16)	3 years
DC-00017	Title search report (series 17)	8 years
DC-00018	Sanction letter (series 18)	5 years
DC-00019	KYC pack (series 19)	10 years
DC-00020	Valuation report (series 20)	7 years
DC-00021	Legal opinion (series 21)	4 years
DC-00022	Insurance certificate (series 22)	9 years
DC-00023	Disbursement memo (series 23)	6 years
DC-00024	Sale deed copy (series 24)	3 years
DC-00025	Title search report (series 25)	8 years
DC-00026	Sanction letter (series 26)	5 years
DC-00027	KYC pack (series 27)	10 years
DC-00028	Valuation report (series 28)	7 years
DC-00029	Legal opinion (series 29)	4 years
DC-00030	Insurance certificate (series 30)	9 years
DC-00031	Disbursement memo (series 31)	6 years
DC-00032	Sale deed copy (series 32)	3 years
DC-00033	Title search report (series 33)	8 years
DC-00034	Sanction letter (series 34)	5 years
DC-00035	KYC pack (series 35)	10 years
DC-00036	Valuation report (series 36)	7 years
DC-00037	Legal opinion (series 37)	4 years
DC-00038	Insurance certificate (series 38)	9 years
DC-00039	Disbursement memo (series 39)	6 years
DC-00040	Sale deed copy (series 40)	3 years
DC-00041	Title search report (series 41)	8 years

Class ID	Document class	Retention after loan closure
DC-00042	Sanction letter (series 42)	5 years
DC-00043	KYC pack (series 43)	10 years
DC-00044	Valuation report (series 44)	7 years
DC-00045	Legal opinion (series 45)	4 years
DC-00046	Insurance certificate (series 46)	9 years
DC-00047	Disbursement memo (series 47)	6 years
DC-00048	Sale deed copy (series 48)	3 years
DC-00049	Title search report (series 49)	8 years
DC-00050	Sanction letter (series 50)	5 years
DC-00051	KYC pack (series 51)	10 years
DC-00052	Valuation report (series 52)	7 years
DC-00053	Legal opinion (series 53)	4 years
DC-00054	Insurance certificate (series 54)	9 years
DC-00055	Disbursement memo (series 55)	6 years
DC-00056	Sale deed copy (series 56)	3 years
DC-00057	Title search report (series 57)	8 years
DC-00058	Sanction letter (series 58)	5 years
DC-00059	KYC pack (series 59)	10 years
DC-00060	Valuation report (series 60)	7 years
DC-00061	Legal opinion (series 61)	4 years
DC-00062	Insurance certificate (series 62)	9 years
DC-00063	Disbursement memo (series 63)	6 years
DC-00064	Sale deed copy (series 64)	3 years
DC-00065	Title search report (series 65)	8 years
DC-00066	Sanction letter (series 66)	5 years
DC-00067	KYC pack (series 67)	10 years
DC-00068	Valuation report (series 68)	7 years
DC-00069	Legal opinion (series 69)	4 years
DC-00070	Insurance certificate (series 70)	9 years
DC-00071	Disbursement memo (series 71)	6 years
DC-00072	Sale deed copy (series 72)	3 years
DC-00073	Title search report (series 73)	8 years
DC-00074	Sanction letter (series 74)	5 years
DC-00075	KYC pack (series 75)	10 years
DC-00076	Valuation report (series 76)	7 years
DC-00077	Legal opinion (series 77)	4 years
DC-00078	Insurance certificate (series 78)	9 years
DC-00079	Disbursement memo (series 79)	6 years
DC-00080	Sale deed copy (series 80)	3 years
DC-00081	Title search report (series 81)	8 years
DC-00082	Sanction letter (series 82)	5 years
DC-00083	KYC pack (series 83)	10 years
DC-00084	Valuation report (series 84)	7 years
DC-00085	Legal opinion (series 85)	4 years

Class ID	Document class	Retention after loan closure
DC-00086	Insurance certificate (series 86)	9 years
DC-00087	Disbursement memo (series 87)	6 years
DC-00088	Sale deed copy (series 88)	3 years
DC-00089	Title search report (series 89)	8 years
DC-00090	Sanction letter (series 90)	5 years
DC-00091	KYC pack (series 91)	10 years
DC-00092	Valuation report (series 92)	7 years
DC-00093	Legal opinion (series 93)	4 years
DC-00094	Insurance certificate (series 94)	9 years
DC-00095	Disbursement memo (series 95)	6 years
DC-00096	Sale deed copy (series 96)	3 years
DC-00097	Title search report (series 97)	8 years
DC-00098	Sanction letter (series 98)	5 years
DC-00099	KYC pack (series 99)	10 years
DC-00100	Valuation report (series 100)	7 years
DC-00101	Legal opinion (series 101)	4 years
DC-00102	Insurance certificate (series 102)	9 years
DC-00103	Disbursement memo (series 103)	6 years
DC-00104	Sale deed copy (series 104)	3 years
DC-00105	Title search report (series 105)	8 years
DC-00106	Sanction letter (series 106)	5 years
DC-00107	KYC pack (series 107)	10 years
DC-00108	Valuation report (series 108)	7 years
DC-00109	Legal opinion (series 109)	4 years
DC-00110	Insurance certificate (series 110)	9 years
DC-00111	Disbursement memo (series 111)	6 years
DC-00112	Sale deed copy (series 112)	3 years
DC-00113	Title search report (series 113)	8 years
DC-00114	Sanction letter (series 114)	5 years
DC-00115	KYC pack (series 115)	10 years
DC-00116	Valuation report (series 116)	7 years
DC-00117	Legal opinion (series 117)	4 years
DC-00118	Insurance certificate (series 118)	9 years
DC-00119	Disbursement memo (series 119)	6 years
DC-00120	Sale deed copy (series 120)	3 years
DC-00121	Title search report (series 121)	8 years
DC-00122	Sanction letter (series 122)	5 years
DC-00123	KYC pack (series 123)	10 years
DC-00124	Valuation report (series 124)	7 years
DC-00125	Legal opinion (series 125)	4 years
DC-00126	Insurance certificate (series 126)	9 years
DC-00127	Disbursement memo (series 127)	6 years
DC-00128	Sale deed copy (series 128)	3 years
DC-00129	Title search report (series 129)	8 years

Class ID	Document class	Retention after loan closure
DC-00130	Sanction letter (series 130)	5 years
DC-00131	KYC pack (series 131)	10 years
DC-00132	Valuation report (series 132)	7 years
DC-00133	Legal opinion (series 133)	4 years
DC-00134	Insurance certificate (series 134)	9 years
DC-00135	Disbursement memo (series 135)	6 years
DC-00136	Sale deed copy (series 136)	3 years
DC-00137	Title search report (series 137)	8 years
DC-00138	Sanction letter (series 138)	5 years
DC-00139	KYC pack (series 139)	10 years
DC-00140	Valuation report (series 140)	7 years
DC-00141	Legal opinion (series 141)	4 years
DC-00142	Insurance certificate (series 142)	9 years
DC-00143	Disbursement memo (series 143)	6 years
DC-00144	Sale deed copy (series 144)	3 years
DC-00145	Title search report (series 145)	8 years
DC-00146	Sanction letter (series 146)	5 years
DC-00147	KYC pack (series 147)	10 years
DC-00148	Valuation report (series 148)	7 years
DC-00149	Legal opinion (series 149)	4 years
DC-00150	Insurance certificate (series 150)	9 years
DC-00151	Disbursement memo (series 151)	6 years
DC-00152	Sale deed copy (series 152)	3 years
DC-00153	Title search report (series 153)	8 years
DC-00154	Sanction letter (series 154)	5 years
DC-00155	KYC pack (series 155)	10 years
DC-00156	Valuation report (series 156)	7 years
DC-00157	Legal opinion (series 157)	4 years
DC-00158	Insurance certificate (series 158)	9 years
DC-00159	Disbursement memo (series 159)	6 years
DC-00160	Sale deed copy (series 160)	3 years
DC-00161	Title search report (series 161)	8 years
DC-00162	Sanction letter (series 162)	5 years
DC-00163	KYC pack (series 163)	10 years
DC-00164	Valuation report (series 164)	7 years
DC-00165	Legal opinion (series 165)	4 years
DC-00166	Insurance certificate (series 166)	9 years
DC-00167	Disbursement memo (series 167)	6 years
DC-00168	Sale deed copy (series 168)	3 years
DC-00169	Title search report (series 169)	8 years
DC-00170	Sanction letter (series 170)	5 years
DC-00171	KYC pack (series 171)	10 years
DC-00172	Valuation report (series 172)	7 years
DC-00173	Legal opinion (series 173)	4 years

Class ID	Document class	Retention after loan closure
DC-00174	Insurance certificate (series 174)	9 years
DC-00175	Disbursement memo (series 175)	6 years
DC-00176	Sale deed copy (series 176)	3 years
DC-00177	Title search report (series 177)	8 years
DC-00178	Sanction letter (series 178)	5 years
DC-00179	KYC pack (series 179)	10 years
DC-00180	Valuation report (series 180)	7 years
DC-00181	Legal opinion (series 181)	4 years
DC-00182	Insurance certificate (series 182)	9 years
DC-00183	Disbursement memo (series 183)	6 years
DC-00184	Sale deed copy (series 184)	3 years
DC-00185	Title search report (series 185)	8 years
DC-00186	Sanction letter (series 186)	5 years
DC-00187	KYC pack (series 187)	10 years
DC-00188	Valuation report (series 188)	7 years
DC-00189	Legal opinion (series 189)	4 years
DC-00190	Insurance certificate (series 190)	9 years
DC-00191	Disbursement memo (series 191)	6 years
DC-00192	Sale deed copy (series 192)	3 years
DC-00193	Title search report (series 193)	8 years
DC-00194	Sanction letter (series 194)	5 years
DC-00195	KYC pack (series 195)	10 years
DC-00196	Valuation report (series 196)	7 years
DC-00197	Legal opinion (series 197)	4 years
DC-00198	Insurance certificate (series 198)	9 years
DC-00199	Disbursement memo (series 199)	6 years
DC-00200	Sale deed copy (series 200)	3 years
DC-00201	Title search report (series 201)	8 years
DC-00202	Sanction letter (series 202)	5 years
DC-00203	KYC pack (series 203)	10 years
DC-00204	Valuation report (series 204)	7 years
DC-00205	Legal opinion (series 205)	4 years
DC-00206	Insurance certificate (series 206)	9 years
DC-00207	Disbursement memo (series 207)	6 years
DC-00208	Sale deed copy (series 208)	3 years
DC-00209	Title search report (series 209)	8 years
DC-00210	Sanction letter (series 210)	5 years
DC-00211	KYC pack (series 211)	10 years
DC-00212	Valuation report (series 212)	7 years
DC-00213	Legal opinion (series 213)	4 years
DC-00214	Insurance certificate (series 214)	9 years
DC-00215	Disbursement memo (series 215)	6 years
DC-00216	Sale deed copy (series 216)	3 years
DC-00217	Title search report (series 217)	8 years

Class ID	Document class	Retention after loan closure
DC-00218	Sanction letter (series 218)	5 years
DC-00219	KYC pack (series 219)	10 years
DC-00220	Valuation report (series 220)	7 years
DC-00221	Legal opinion (series 221)	4 years
DC-00222	Insurance certificate (series 222)	9 years
DC-00223	Disbursement memo (series 223)	6 years
DC-00224	Sale deed copy (series 224)	3 years
DC-00225	Title search report (series 225)	8 years
DC-00226	Sanction letter (series 226)	5 years
DC-00227	KYC pack (series 227)	10 years
DC-00228	Valuation report (series 228)	7 years
DC-00229	Legal opinion (series 229)	4 years
DC-00230	Insurance certificate (series 230)	9 years
DC-00231	Disbursement memo (series 231)	6 years
DC-00232	Sale deed copy (series 232)	3 years
DC-00233	Title search report (series 233)	8 years
DC-00234	Sanction letter (series 234)	5 years
DC-00235	KYC pack (series 235)	10 years
DC-00236	Valuation report (series 236)	7 years
DC-00237	Legal opinion (series 237)	4 years
DC-00238	Insurance certificate (series 238)	9 years
DC-00239	Disbursement memo (series 239)	6 years
DC-00240	Sale deed copy (series 240)	3 years
DC-00241	Title search report (series 241)	8 years
DC-00242	Sanction letter (series 242)	5 years
DC-00243	KYC pack (series 243)	10 years
DC-00244	Valuation report (series 244)	7 years
DC-00245	Legal opinion (series 245)	4 years
DC-00246	Insurance certificate (series 246)	9 years
DC-00247	Disbursement memo (series 247)	6 years
DC-00248	Sale deed copy (series 248)	3 years
DC-00249	Title search report (series 249)	8 years
DC-00250	Sanction letter (series 250)	5 years
DC-00251	KYC pack (series 251)	10 years
DC-00252	Valuation report (series 252)	7 years
DC-00253	Legal opinion (series 253)	4 years
DC-00254	Insurance certificate (series 254)	9 years
DC-00255	Disbursement memo (series 255)	6 years
DC-00256	Sale deed copy (series 256)	3 years
DC-00257	Title search report (series 257)	8 years
DC-00258	Sanction letter (series 258)	5 years
DC-00259	KYC pack (series 259)	10 years
DC-00260	Valuation report (series 260)	7 years
DC-00261	Legal opinion (series 261)	4 years

Class ID	Document class	Retention after loan closure
DC-00262	Insurance certificate (series 262)	9 years
DC-00263	Disbursement memo (series 263)	6 years
DC-00264	Sale deed copy (series 264)	3 years
DC-00265	Title search report (series 265)	8 years
DC-00266	Sanction letter (series 266)	5 years
DC-00267	KYC pack (series 267)	10 years
DC-00268	Valuation report (series 268)	7 years
DC-00269	Legal opinion (series 269)	4 years
DC-00270	Insurance certificate (series 270)	9 years
DC-00271	Disbursement memo (series 271)	6 years
DC-00272	Sale deed copy (series 272)	3 years
DC-00273	Title search report (series 273)	8 years
DC-00274	Sanction letter (series 274)	5 years
DC-00275	KYC pack (series 275)	10 years
DC-00276	Valuation report (series 276)	7 years
DC-00277	Legal opinion (series 277)	4 years
DC-00278	Insurance certificate (series 278)	9 years
DC-00279	Disbursement memo (series 279)	6 years
DC-00280	Sale deed copy (series 280)	3 years
DC-00281	Title search report (series 281)	8 years
DC-00282	Sanction letter (series 282)	5 years
DC-00283	KYC pack (series 283)	10 years
DC-00284	Valuation report (series 284)	7 years
DC-00285	Legal opinion (series 285)	4 years
DC-00286	Insurance certificate (series 286)	9 years
DC-00287	Disbursement memo (series 287)	6 years
DC-00288	Sale deed copy (series 288)	3 years
DC-00289	Title search report (series 289)	8 years
DC-00290	Sanction letter (series 290)	5 years
DC-00291	KYC pack (series 291)	10 years
DC-00292	Valuation report (series 292)	7 years
DC-00293	Legal opinion (series 293)	4 years
DC-00294	Insurance certificate (series 294)	9 years
DC-00295	Disbursement memo (series 295)	6 years
DC-00296	Sale deed copy (series 296)	3 years
DC-00297	Title search report (series 297)	8 years
DC-00298	Sanction letter (series 298)	5 years
DC-00299	KYC pack (series 299)	10 years
DC-00300	Valuation report (series 300)	7 years
DC-00301	Legal opinion (series 301)	4 years
DC-00302	Insurance certificate (series 302)	9 years
DC-00303	Disbursement memo (series 303)	6 years
DC-00304	Sale deed copy (series 304)	3 years
DC-00305	Title search report (series 305)	8 years

Class ID	Document class	Retention after loan closure
DC-00306	Sanction letter (series 306)	5 years
DC-00307	KYC pack (series 307)	10 years
DC-00308	Valuation report (series 308)	7 years
DC-00309	Legal opinion (series 309)	4 years
DC-00310	Insurance certificate (series 310)	9 years
DC-00311	Disbursement memo (series 311)	6 years
DC-00312	Sale deed copy (series 312)	3 years
DC-00313	Title search report (series 313)	8 years
DC-00314	Sanction letter (series 314)	5 years
DC-00315	KYC pack (series 315)	10 years
DC-00316	Valuation report (series 316)	7 years
DC-00317	Legal opinion (series 317)	4 years
DC-00318	Insurance certificate (series 318)	9 years
DC-00319	Disbursement memo (series 319)	6 years
DC-00320	Sale deed copy (series 320)	3 years
DC-00321	Title search report (series 321)	8 years
DC-00322	Sanction letter (series 322)	5 years
DC-00323	KYC pack (series 323)	10 years
DC-00324	Valuation report (series 324)	7 years
DC-00325	Legal opinion (series 325)	4 years
DC-00326	Insurance certificate (series 326)	9 years
DC-00327	Disbursement memo (series 327)	6 years
DC-00328	Sale deed copy (series 328)	3 years
DC-00329	Title search report (series 329)	8 years
DC-00330	Sanction letter (series 330)	5 years
DC-00331	KYC pack (series 331)	10 years
DC-00332	Valuation report (series 332)	7 years
DC-00333	Legal opinion (series 333)	4 years
DC-00334	Insurance certificate (series 334)	9 years
DC-00335	Disbursement memo (series 335)	6 years
DC-00336	Sale deed copy (series 336)	3 years
DC-00337	Title search report (series 337)	8 years
DC-00338	Sanction letter (series 338)	5 years
DC-00339	KYC pack (series 339)	10 years
DC-00340	Valuation report (series 340)	7 years
DC-00341	Legal opinion (series 341)	4 years
DC-00342	Insurance certificate (series 342)	9 years
DC-00343	Disbursement memo (series 343)	6 years
DC-00344	Sale deed copy (series 344)	3 years
DC-00345	Title search report (series 345)	8 years
DC-00346	Sanction letter (series 346)	5 years
DC-00347	KYC pack (series 347)	10 years
DC-00348	Valuation report (series 348)	7 years
DC-00349	Legal opinion (series 349)	4 years

Class ID	Document class	Retention after loan closure
DC-00350	Insurance certificate (series 350)	9 years
DC-00351	Disbursement memo (series 351)	6 years
DC-00352	Sale deed copy (series 352)	3 years
DC-00353	Title search report (series 353)	8 years
DC-00354	Sanction letter (series 354)	5 years
DC-00355	KYC pack (series 355)	10 years
DC-00356	Valuation report (series 356)	7 years
DC-00357	Legal opinion (series 357)	4 years
DC-00358	Insurance certificate (series 358)	9 years
DC-00359	Disbursement memo (series 359)	6 years
DC-00360	Sale deed copy (series 360)	3 years
DC-00361	Title search report (series 361)	8 years
DC-00362	Sanction letter (series 362)	5 years
DC-00363	KYC pack (series 363)	10 years
DC-00364	Valuation report (series 364)	7 years
DC-00365	Legal opinion (series 365)	4 years
DC-00366	Insurance certificate (series 366)	9 years
DC-00367	Disbursement memo (series 367)	6 years
DC-00368	Sale deed copy (series 368)	3 years
DC-00369	Title search report (series 369)	8 years
DC-00370	Sanction letter (series 370)	5 years
DC-00371	KYC pack (series 371)	10 years
DC-00372	Valuation report (series 372)	7 years
DC-00373	Legal opinion (series 373)	4 years
DC-00374	Insurance certificate (series 374)	9 years
DC-00375	Disbursement memo (series 375)	6 years
DC-00376	Sale deed copy (series 376)	3 years
DC-00377	Title search report (series 377)	8 years
DC-00378	Sanction letter (series 378)	5 years
DC-00379	KYC pack (series 379)	10 years
DC-00380	Valuation report (series 380)	7 years
DC-00381	Legal opinion (series 381)	4 years
DC-00382	Insurance certificate (series 382)	9 years
DC-00383	Disbursement memo (series 383)	6 years
DC-00384	Sale deed copy (series 384)	3 years
DC-00385	Title search report (series 385)	8 years
DC-00386	Sanction letter (series 386)	5 years
DC-00387	KYC pack (series 387)	10 years
DC-00388	Valuation report (series 388)	7 years
DC-00389	Legal opinion (series 389)	4 years
DC-00390	Insurance certificate (series 390)	9 years
DC-00391	Disbursement memo (series 391)	6 years
DC-00392	Sale deed copy (series 392)	3 years
DC-00393	Title search report (series 393)	8 years

Class ID	Document class	Retention after loan closure
DC-00394	Sanction letter (series 394)	5 years
DC-00395	KYC pack (series 395)	10 years
DC-00396	Valuation report (series 396)	7 years
DC-00397	Legal opinion (series 397)	4 years
DC-00398	Insurance certificate (series 398)	9 years
DC-00399	Disbursement memo (series 399)	6 years
DC-00400	Sale deed copy (series 400)	3 years

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End of Document - Mortgage Loan Policy v5.0